Deep Learning Group Project – Sentiment Classification of Movie Reviews (IMDB dataset)

Students: D00225328 Jubilee Osowa
D00285904 Guilherme Sonego Neto
D00285895 George Semain

Programme: PGDip Applied Data Science
Module: SWRDC9011 Machine Learning and AI with Industrial Applications
Lecturer: Dr. Sargam Yadav
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Step 0 – Problem Identification

Real-world problems suitable for applying machine learning and deep learning models

A project kick-off meeting, attended by all three students, considered the Project Brief and performed a non-exhaustive research of various real-world text and image problems that could be alternatives for implementation:

- Positive or Negative classification of the sentiment of user movie reviews
- Detection of fake news articles
- Classifying received e-mails as spam or legitimate
- Categorising news articles
- Classification of helpdesk support tickets
- Product review star-rating prediction
- Image classification of handwritten digits (the MNIST standard dataset)
- Medical image classification (presence/absence of a disease)
- Object recognition within images (such as classification of dog breeds)
- Detection of language of a piece of text

These alternatives span both Natural Language Processing and Computer Vision domains and demonstrate real-world applications across industry sectors such as media, healthcare,

customer service, information security.

The discussion showed that there are many possible text-based and image-based problems that could be addressed using machine learning.

Both text and image related problems were considered, and it was agreed by the group to use a text-based problem on the basis that transformer-based language models (such as BERT) are very good at natural language processing, and it was considered that text-based data was likely to be more readily available than suitable image datasets, and would require less pre-processing than image datasets.

We agreed to implement a binary sentiment classification (positive or negative) of user movie reviews.

Step 1 – Problem Understanding

The *Internet Movie Database*, known as IMDb, was founded in 1990 and is an online information platform for films, TV programmes, gaming and streaming content. The URL is www.imdb.com.

One of the key features of the platform enables users to rate movies and to post reviews. The user ratings are given as a score between 1 (poor) and 10 (excellent) for each movie. User ratings are used by the platform's algorithm to generate an aggregated score for each movie. User reviews are generally a guide to potential viewers and help determine if they should watch the movies. Both reviews and ratings are used by the platform to influence a movie's overall score.

A *review* is a text-based comment attributed to a movie, posted by a registered user of the platform. The 'sentiment' of a review is a binary classification of whether the review is *positive* or *negative*. In addition to quantitative *ratings*, it is the sentiment of user reviews that influence how a movie is scored.

It is therefore necessary for the platform to be able to determine a binary classification (positive or negative) of the sentiment of a user review.

The objective of this project is to train and compare three models for sentiment classification and evaluate their performance.

Proposed Solution

In particular, the project will 'solve' the problem by implementing and comparing three types of models:

- a traditional machine learning **Logistic Regression model** with TF-IDF

- a standard deep learning **LSTM model**
- a transformer-based deep learning **BERT model**

Implementation Approach

The second project meeting, attended by all three students, agreed the problem statement and proposed solution.
The following implementation approach was agreed

1. Select a real-world problem to apply machine learning and deep learning techniques
2. Identify a suitable dataset and load it
3. Perform exploratory data analysis to understand the data
4. Process the data so that it can be used by models
5. Build (train and test) the three models
6. Compare the models' performance
7. Explain key learnings and potential future work

Team Work

It was agreed that each student would implement a different model

- George -> Logistic Regression with TF-IDF
- Guilherme -> LSTM model
- Jubilee -> BERT model

All other stages of the project would be a collaboration by all three students working together.

It was agreed to use the Google Colab Notebook platform to enable all three students to work simultaneously on the same Python Notebook.

Step 2 – Data Preparation

An internet search was conducted to identify available movie user review datasets of at least 10,000 samples, and labelled with positive or negative sentiment.

It was agreed to use the Hugging Face IMDb Movie Reviews Dataset which includes 50,000 movie reviews labelled as either positive or negative, which can be loaded by installing the Hugging Face *datasets* Python library, and loading the 'imdb' dataset.

The library documentation notes that a '0' value for the label represents a negative sentiment, and a '1' value for the label represents a positive sentiment. It also explains that the dataset comes pre-split into a training dataset and a testing dataset.

In [ ]:
```
# it is necessary to install the 'datasets' library
#!pip install datasets
```

In [ ]:
```
from datasets import load_dataset
import pandas as pd
```

In [ ]:
```
from datasets import load_dataset
dataset = load_dataset("imdb")
```

```
/usr/local/lib/python3.12/dist-packages/huggingface_hub/utils/_auth.py:93: UserWarni
ng:
The secret `HF_TOKEN` does not exist in your Colab secrets.
To authenticate with the Hugging Face Hub, create a token in your settings tab (http
s://huggingface.co/settings/tokens), set it as secret in your Google Colab and resta
rt your session.
You will be able to reuse this secret in all of your notebooks.
Please note that authentication is recommended but still optional to access public m
odels or datasets.
  warnings.warn(
```

In [ ]:
```
print(dataset)
```

```
DatasetDict({
    train: Dataset({
        features: ['text', 'label'],
        num_rows: 25000
    })
    test: Dataset({
        features: ['text', 'label'],
        num_rows: 25000
    })
    unsupervised: Dataset({
        features: ['text', 'label'],
        num_rows: 50000
    })
})
```

This clearly shows that the dataset is structured like a dictionary, with a training set of 25,000 rows and a testing set of 25,000 rows.

However, one of the important steps in data preparation is to ensure that the data is balanced with equal proportions of positive and negative labels in both sets. This is important in classification models to prevent model bias in predicting one class more frequently than the other.

Rather than assume this is the case, before using the pre-split data, it is important to check the data is balanced.

In [ ]:
```
df_train = pd.DataFrame(dataset["train"])
df_test = pd.DataFrame(dataset["test"])

print("Distribution of the Training Set")
print(df_train["label"].value_counts())
```

```
print("\nDistribution of the Test Set")
print(df_test["label"].value_counts())
```

```
Distribution of the Training Set
label
0    12500
1    12500
Name: count, dtype: int64

Distribution of the Test Set
label
0    12500
1    12500
Name: count, dtype: int64
```

This is excellent, as it confirms there is an equal number of positive and negative sentiment reviews in each dataset (12,500 of each in each dataset).

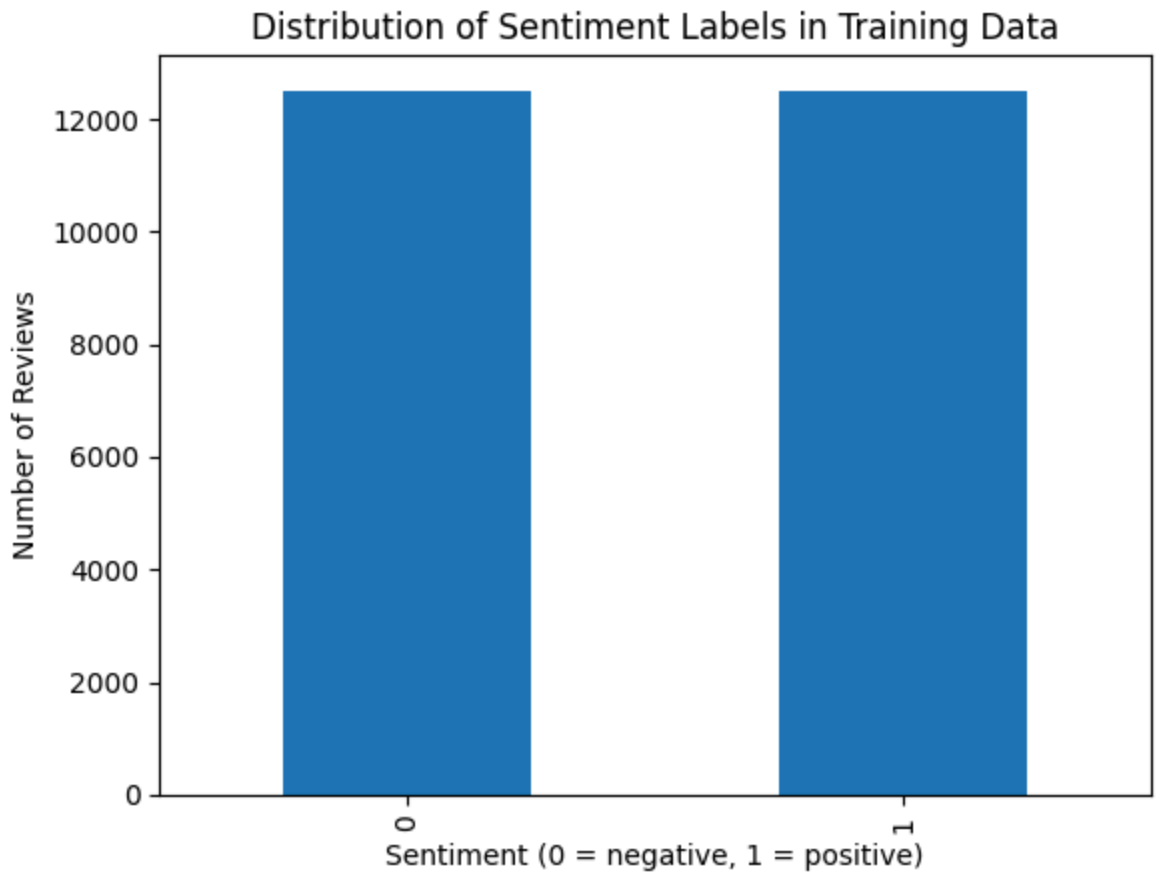
This can be further evidenced through a simple visualisation.

In [ ]:
```
import matplotlib.pyplot as plt

df_train["label"].value_counts().plot(kind="bar")

plt.title("Distribution of Sentiment Labels in Training Data")
plt.xlabel("Sentiment (0 = negative, 1 = positive)")
plt.ylabel("Number of Reviews")

plt.show()
```



To assist with data exploration, the data was loaded to a Pandas dataframe.

In [ ]:
```
df_train = pd.DataFrame(dataset["train"])
df_train.head()
```

Out[ ]:

	text	label
0	I rented I AM CURIOUS-YELLOW from my video sto...	0
1	"I Am Curious: Yellow" is a risible and preten...	0
2	If only to avoid making this type of film in t...	0
3	This film was probably inspired by Godard's Ma...	0
4	Oh, brother...after hearing about this ridicul...	0

In [ ]:
```
df_test = pd.DataFrame(dataset["test"])
df_test.head()
```

Out[ ]:

	text	label
0	I love sci-fi and am willing to put up with a ...	0
1	Worth the entertainment value of a rental, esp...	0
2	its a totally average film with a few semi-alr...	0
3	STAR RATING: ***** Saturday Night **** Friday ...	0
4	First off let me say, If you haven't enjoyed a...	0

Step 3 – Exploration of Data

Examine the length (number of characters) of each user review

It is important to consider the length of the text of each review as models must be able to handle both short and long text. This is of relevance in LSTM and transformer models.

In [ ]:

```
df_train["review_length"] = df_train["text"].str.len()
df_train["review_length"].describe()
```

Out[ ]:

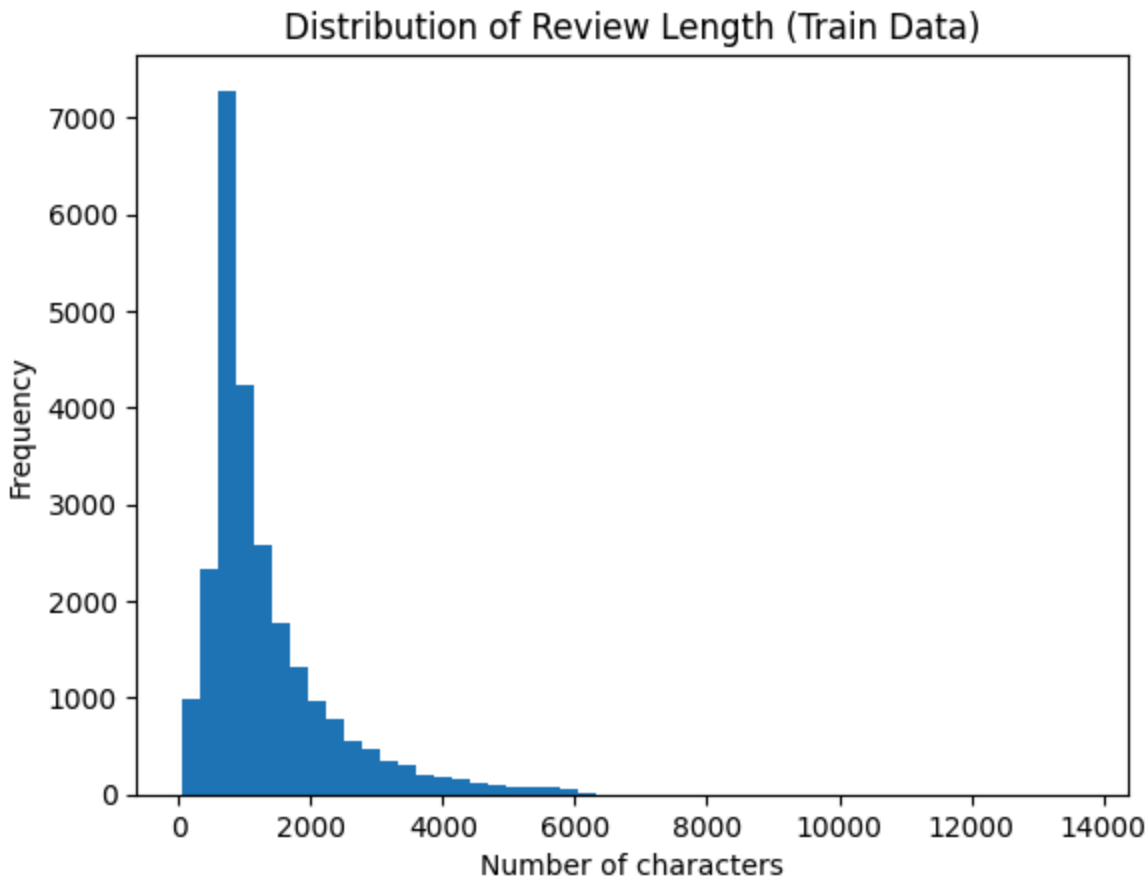
	review_length
count	25000.00000
mean	1325.06964
std	1003.13367
min	52.00000
25%	702.00000
50%	979.00000
75%	1614.00000
max	13704.00000

dtype: float64

In [ ]:

```
plt.hist(df_train["review_length"], bins=50)
plt.title("Distribution of Review Length (Train Data)")
plt.xlabel("Number of characters")
plt.ylabel("Frequency")

plt.show()
```



This is clearly a right-skewed distribution, showing a long tail extending to the right, and most observations on the low side (left).

In [ ]:
```
df_test["review_length"] = df_test["text"].str.len()
df_test["review_length"].describe()
```

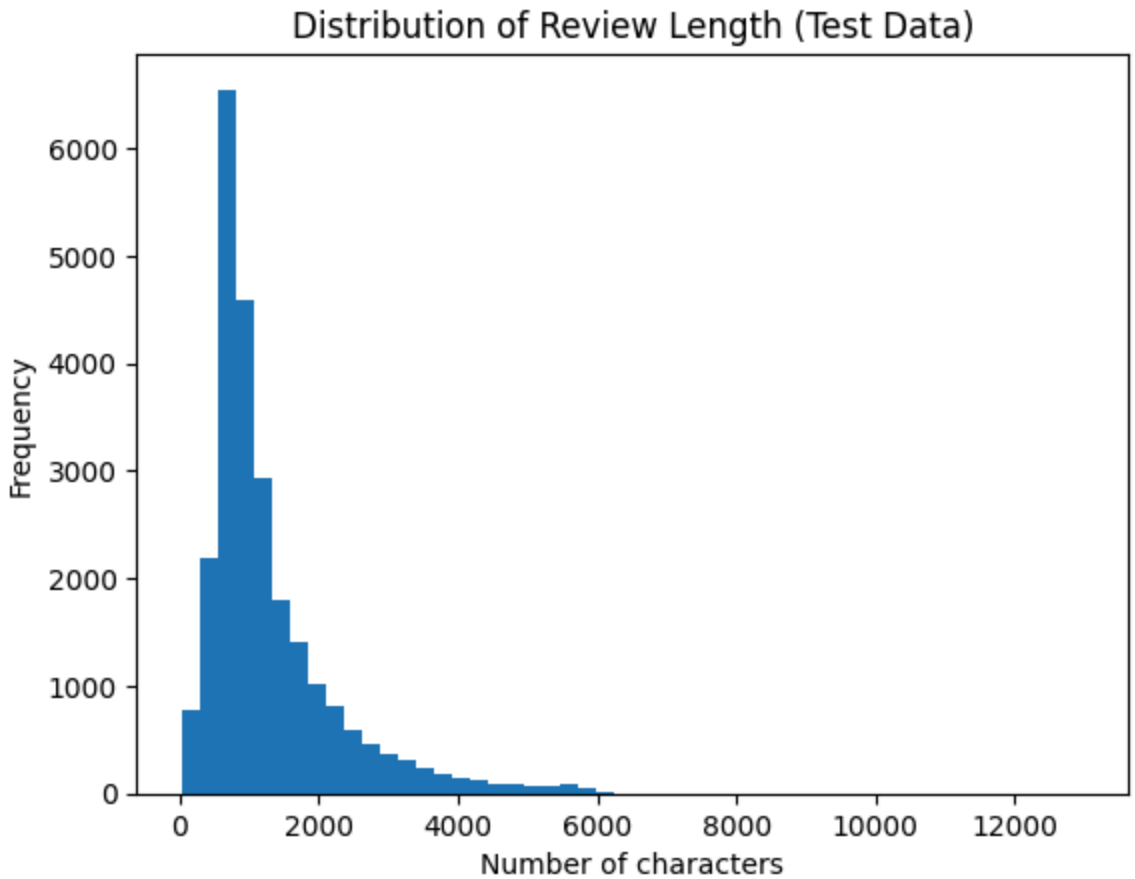
Out[ ]:

	review_length
count	25000.00000
mean	1293.79240
std	975.90776
min	32.00000
25%	696.00000
50%	962.00000
75%	1572.00000
max	12988.00000

dtype: float64

In [ ]:
```
plt.hist(df_test["review_length"], bins=50)
plt.title("Distribution of Review Length (Test Data)")
plt.xlabel("Number of characters")
plt.ylabel("Frequency")

plt.show()
```



This is also clearly a right-skewed distribution.

Both histograms show that there is considerable variation in review lengths, and models will need to be able to process both short text and long text. As both follow a similar right-skewed distribution. This suggests that both the training and test datasets follow a similar distribution, which is desirable for modelling.

In [ ]:
```
df_train["review_length"].mean()
```

Out[ ]:
```
np.float64(1325.06964)
```

In [ ]:
```
df_test["review_length"].mean()
```

Out[ ]:
```
np.float64(1293.7924)
```

The average review length for both the training data (1,325 characters) and testing data (1,293) is very similar. This represents a substantial length of text for sentiment analysis modeling.

Show the proportion of positive and negative reviews

In [ ]:
```
df_train["label"].value_counts(normalize=True)
```

Out[ ]:

label	proportion
0	0.5
1	0.5

dtype: float64

There is an equal number of positive and negative reviews (balanced data labels).

Show examples of positive and negative reviews

In [ ]:
```
print("Example Positive Review:\n")
print(df_train[df_train["label"] == 1]["text"].iloc[0])

print("\n\nExample Negative Review:\n")
print(df_train[df_train["label"] == 0]["text"].iloc[0])
```

```
Example Positive Review:

Zentropa has much in common with The Third Man, another noir-like film set among the
rubble of postwar Europe. Like TTM, there is much inventive camera work. There is an
innocent American who gets emotionally involved with a woman he doesn't really under
stand, and whose naivety is all the more striking in contrast with the natives.<br /
><br />But I'd have to say that The Third Man has a more well-crafted storyline. Zen
tropa is a bit disjointed in this respect. Perhaps this is intentional: it is presen
ted as a dream/nightmare, and making it too coherent would spoil the effect. <br /><
br />This movie is unrelentingly grim--"noir" in more than one sense; one never sees
the sun shine. Grim, but intriguing, and frightening.


Example Negative Review:

I rented I AM CURIOUS-YELLOW from my video store because of all the controversy that
surrounded it when it was first released in 1967. I also heard that at first it was
seized by U.S. customs if it ever tried to enter this country, therefore being a fan
of films considered "controversial" I really had to see this for myself.<br /><br />
The plot is centered around a young Swedish drama student named Lena who wants to le
arn everything she can about life. In particular she wants to focus her attentions t
o making some sort of documentary on what the average Swede thought about certain po
litical issues such as the Vietnam War and race issues in the United States. In betw
een asking politicians and ordinary denizens of Stockholm about their opinions on po
litics, she has sex with her drama teacher, classmates, and married men.<br /><br />
What kills me about I AM CURIOUS-YELLOW is that 40 years ago, this was considered po
rnographic. Really, the sex and nudity scenes are few and far between, even then i
t's not shot like some cheaply made porno. While my countrymen mind find it shockin
g, in reality sex and nudity are a major staple in Swedish cinema. Even Ingmar Bergm
an, arguably their answer to good old boy John Ford, had sex scenes in his films.<br
/><br />I do commend the filmmakers for the fact that any sex shown in the film is s
hown for artistic purposes rather than just to shock people and make money to be sho
wn in pornographic theaters in America. I AM CURIOUS-YELLOW is a good film for anyon
e wanting to study the meat and potatoes (no pun intended) of Swedish cinema. But re
ally, this film doesn't have much of a plot.
```

To avoid having to scroll the output, this can be resolved by setting a text-wrap width.

In [ ]:

```python
import textwrap

print("Example Positive Review:\n")

print(textwrap.fill(
    df_train[df_train["label"] == 1]["text"].iloc[0],
    width=100
))

print("\n\nExample Negative Review:\n")

print(textwrap.fill(
    df_train[df_train["label"] == 0]["text"].iloc[0],
    width=100
))
```

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more striking in contrast with the natives.

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more well-crafted storyline. Zentropa is a bit disjointed in this respect. Perhaps this is
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effect.

This movie is unrelentingly grim--"noir" in more than one sense; one never sees
the sun shine. Grim, but intriguing, and frightening.

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AM CURIOUS-YELLOW is a good film for anyone wanting to study the meat and potatoes (no pun intended)
of Swedish cinema. But really, this film doesn't have much of a plot.

Reading the example reviews, it is possible to observe some markup language tags, such as `<br /><br />`. These can be removed.

In [ ]:
```
df_train["text"] = df_train["text"].str.replace("<br />", " ", regex=False)
df_test["text"] = df_test["text"].str.replace("<br />", " ", regex=False)
```

In [ ]:
```
from IPython.display import Markdown, display
import textwrap

pos_review = textwrap.fill(
    df_train[df_train["label"] == 1]["text"].iloc[0],
    width=100
)

neg_review = textwrap.fill(
    df_train[df_train["label"] == 0]["text"].iloc[0],
    width=100
)

display(Markdown(f"### Example Positive Review\n\n{pos_review}"))
display(Markdown(f"### Example Negative Review\n\n{neg_review}"))
```

Example Positive Review

Zentropa has much in common with The Third Man, another noir-like film set among the rubble of postwar Europe. Like TTM, there is much inventive camera work. There is an innocent American who gets emotionally involved with a woman he doesn't really understand, and whose naivety is all the more striking in contrast with the natives. But I'd have to say that The Third Man has a more well- crafted storyline. Zentropa is a bit disjointed in this respect. Perhaps this is intentional: it is presented as a dream/nightmare, and making it too coherent would spoil the effect. This movie is unrelentingly grim--"noir" in more than one sense; one never sees the sun shine. Grim, but intriguing, and frightening.

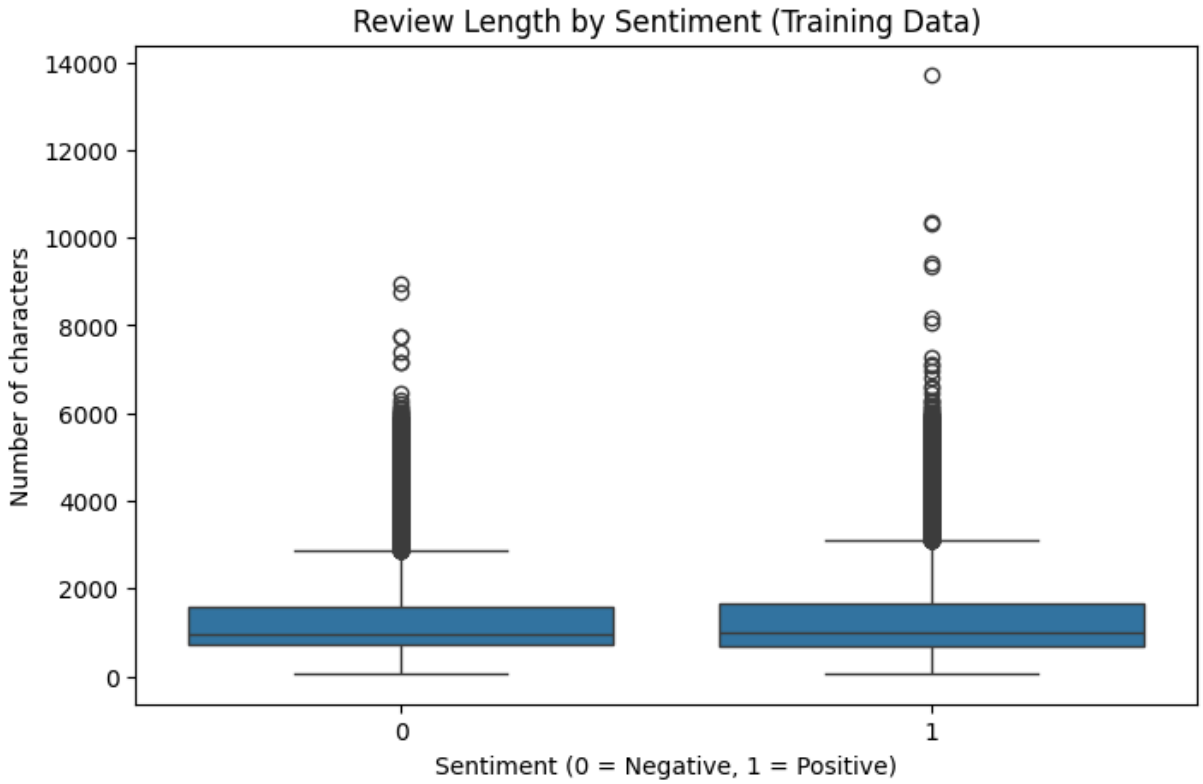
Example Negative Review

I rented I AM CURIOUS-YELLOW from my video store because of all the controversy that surrounded it when it was first released in 1967. I also heard that at first it was seized by U.S. customs if it ever tried to enter this country, therefore being a fan of films considered "controversial" I really had to see this for myself. The plot is centered around a young Swedish drama student named Lena who wants to learn everything she can about life. In particular she wants to focus her attentions to making some sort of documentary on what the average Swede thought about certain political issues such as the Vietnam War and race issues in the United States. In between asking politicians and ordinary denizens of Stockholm about their opinions on politics, she has sex with her drama teacher, classmates, and married men. What kills me about I AM CURIOUS-YELLOW is that 40 years ago, this was considered pornographic. Really, the sex and nudity scenes are few and far between, even then it's not shot like some cheaply made porno. While my countrymen mind find it shocking, in reality sex and nudity are a major staple in Swedish cinema. Even Ingmar Bergman, arguably their answer to good old boy John Ford, had sex scenes in his films. I do commend the filmmakers for the fact that any sex shown in the film is shown for artistic purposes rather than just to shock people and make money to be shown in pornographic theaters in America. I AM CURIOUS-YELLOW is a good film for anyone wanting to study the meat and potatoes (no pun intended) of Swedish cinema. But really, this film doesn't have much of a plot.

Explore Relationship of Review Length and Label Value

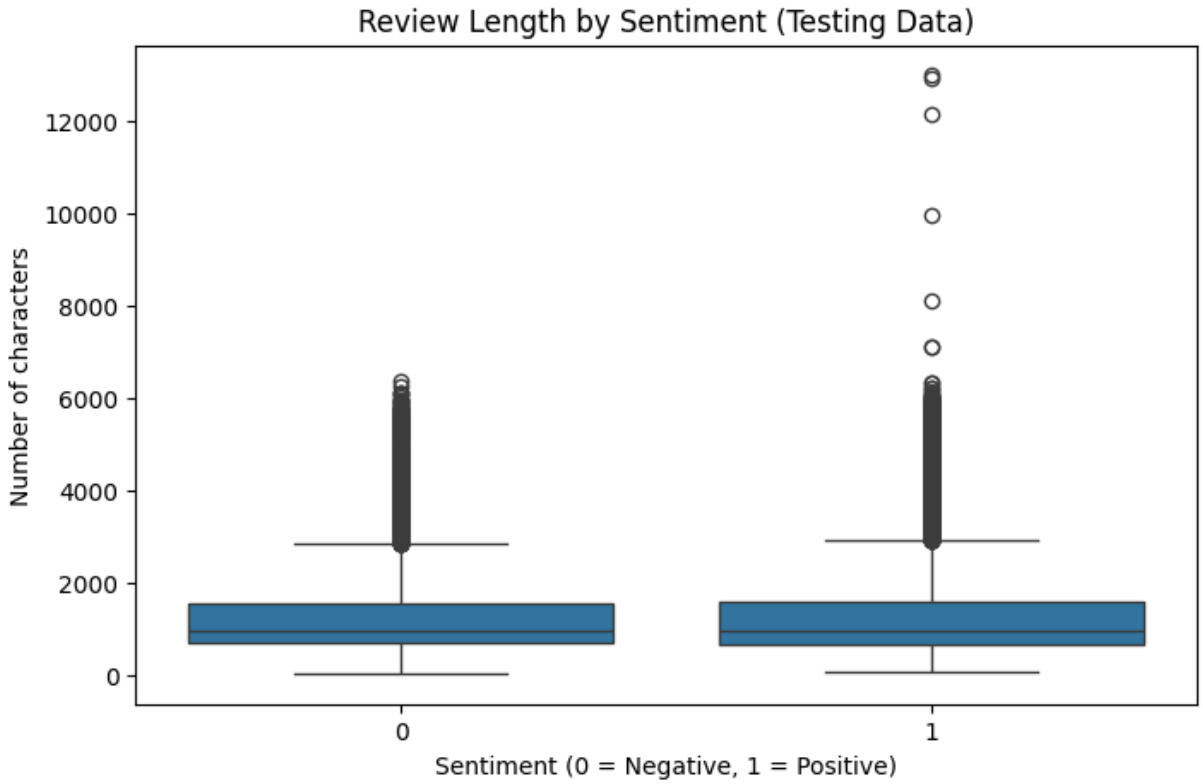
We explore whether review length has any relationship with sentiment. For example, a negative review could potentially be longer if the user provided longer explanation to justify how they were dissatisfied, whereas positive reviews could be more concise, on the basis the user may not feel it necessary to go into detail why they liked it.

In [ ]:
```
import seaborn as sns
import matplotlib.pyplot as plt

plt.figure(figsize=(8,5))

sns.boxplot(
    x="label",
    y="review_length",
    data=df_train
)

plt.title("Review Length by Sentiment (Training Data)")
plt.xlabel("Sentiment (0 = Negative, 1 = Positive)")
plt.ylabel("Number of characters")

plt.show()
```



In [ ]:

```
import seaborn as sns
import matplotlib.pyplot as plt

plt.figure(figsize=(8,5))

sns.boxplot(
    x="label",
    y="review_length",
    data=df_test
)

plt.title("Review Length by Sentiment (Testing Data)")
plt.xlabel("Sentiment (0 = Negative, 1 = Positive)")
plt.ylabel("Number of characters")

plt.show()
```



In [ ]:
```
df_train.groupby("label")["review_length"].mean()
```

Out[ ]:

	review_length
label	
0	1302.97904
1	1347.16024

dtype: float64

In [ ]:
```
df_test.groupby("label")["review_length"].mean()
```

Out[ ]:

	review_length
label	
0	1285.14968
1	1302.43512

dtype: float64

The difference in average review length between positive and negative sentiment is small, suggesting that review length alone is not a strong predictor of sentiment. The mean review lengths are slightly lower in testing dataset than the training dataset, although the same order of magnitude.

Step 4 – Feature Engineering & Representation

Models cannot work directly with raw text, so it must first be converted into numerical form.

Different types of models require different forms of representation. This is the case for the models we have selected:

- **Logistic Regression** requires numerical feature vectors. In general, it isn't sophisticated to understand word order.
- **LSTM** requires tokenised and padded sequences. It is better than logistic regression at understanding word order.
- **BERT** requires specialised transformer tokenisation. It is better than Logistic Regression and LSTM in understanding word meaning and context

On this basis, different representation techniques have to be applied for each model.

4.1 TF-IDF Representation (for Logistic Regression)

Traditional machine learning models such as logistic regression cannot work directly from raw text (computer processors understand numbers, not text), hence it is necessary to convert the text into numerical representations of the text (vectors) that enable patterns within the text to be represented.

Term Frequency (TF) is a technique that counts how many times a particular word is found in the text (in this case a user review). Hence words that appear more frequently have a higher value. Small words (for example, of, the, in, at, ...) are insignificant to the meaning of the review but can appear frequently - hence these 'stopwords' are excluded from the representation.

Inverse Document Frequency (IDF) is another technique that looks across all of the text (all reviews) to determine how rare a word is. Words that do not appear very often can have more significance and meaning than words that appear very frequently, hence IDF gives a higher score for words that do not appear frequently across all reviews.

By taking the product TF * IDF, a word gets a high score when it appears frequently in a review and is not frequently used across all reviews. In this way, every word (the total

vocabulary excluding stopwords) can be given a score for a particular review. Those numerical values per word form the vector representation for the review. This is the way that a review text (words) can be represented as a consistent numerical vector using **TF-IDF** encoding. Some words in the vocabulary will not appear in the review and will score zero in the vector. The higher the numerical representation for a word, the more important that word is considered to be.

In [ ]:
```
from sklearn.feature_extraction.text import TfidfVectorizer
from sklearn.model_selection import train_test_split

# create a validation set from the training data set only
# (keeping the test data set completely separate)
# use stratify to preserve a balanced data between training and validation sets
# use 20% of the test data set for validation
X_train_text_lg, X_val_text_lg, y_train_lg, y_val_lg = train_test_split(
    df_train["text"],
    df_train["label"],
    test_size=0.20,
    stratify=df_train["label"],
    random_state=42
)

# keep the official test set separate
X_test_text_lg = df_test["text"]
y_test_lg = df_test["label"]

# create TF-IDF vectorizer
# using the 10,000 most informative features
# ignore small insignificant stopwords
# include both single words (e.g. "excellent") and two-word combinations (e.g. "not
tfidf_vectorizer_lg = TfidfVectorizer(
    max_features=10000,
    stop_words="english",
    ngram_range=(1, 2)
)

# fit on training data only, then transform validation and test data
X_train_tfidf_lg = tfidf_vectorizer_lg.fit_transform(X_train_text_lg)
X_val_tfidf_lg = tfidf_vectorizer_lg.transform(X_val_text_lg)
X_test_tfidf_lg = tfidf_vectorizer_lg.transform(X_test_text_lg)

print("TF-IDF training matrix shape:", X_train_tfidf_lg.shape)
print("TF-IDF validation matrix shape:", X_val_tfidf_lg.shape)
print("TF-IDF test matrix shape:", X_test_tfidf_lg.shape)
```

```
TF-IDF training matrix shape: (20000, 10000)
TF-IDF validation matrix shape: (5000, 10000)
TF-IDF test matrix shape: (25000, 10000)
```

The training data was further split into two subsets a) 80% training and b) 20% validation, and the balance of negative and positive sentiment labels was maintained using stratified sampling.

Numerical representation of the text using TF-IDF encoding was then fitted on the training text only, before transforming the validation and test text.

This produced numerical matrices to represent the significance/importance of words within each review. The Logistic Regression Model is able to use the matrices as input.

In [ ]:
```
feature_names_lg = tfidf_vectorizer_lg.get_feature_names_out()
print("Number of TF-IDF features:", len(feature_names_lg))
```

```
Number of TF-IDF features: 10000
```

Each word in the vocabulary will have a score in every review (could be 0). By taking the average of all scores for a word (the average TF-IDF) and ranking them to see the words with the highest average TF-IDF score, these are the words that are relatively prominent across all of the text (corpus). High average TF-IDF score does not necessarily mean that the word is important in predicting sentiment. This is determined later through the model training when Logistic Regression determines a weighting (coefficient) for each word.

A lot of reviews are going to contain words that appear frequently across all reviews (such as the word movie, or film, or actor). These aren't indicative of sentiment yet they could score high with TF-IDF.

In [ ]:
```
import numpy as np

mean_tfidf_lg = X_train_tfidf_lg.mean(axis=0).A1
top_indices_lg = np.argsort(mean_tfidf_lg)[-20:][::-1]

top_terms_lg = [(feature_names_lg[i], mean_tfidf_lg[i]) for i in top_indices_lg]
top_terms_lg[:10]
```

Out[ ]:
```
[('movie', np.float64(0.0501109480815725)),
 ('film', np.float64(0.0428861747693479)),
 ('like', np.float64(0.024329167370427753)),
 ('just', np.float64(0.022769154106576216)),
 ('good', np.float64(0.021418593926216083)),
 ('really', np.float64(0.018138132381982548)),
 ('story', np.float64(0.01806698171233778)),
 ('time', np.float64(0.018053724755148715)),
 ('bad', np.float64(0.017034486805470504)),
 ('great', np.float64(0.015603872826541949))]
```

These are words that are relatively frequent in reviews, not removed as stopwords, and moderately informative across many documents. But of course, a high TF-IDF on its own does not necessarily mean it has a significance to predict a specific sentiment. They are words important across the entire text (all reviews) - we need the model training to determine which words help predict sentiment (refer later section 5.1)

As two-word combinations can be important, it is interesting to check TF-IDF two-word combinations exists.

In [ ]:
```
bigrams_lg = [f for f in feature_names_lg if " " in f]

print(bigrams_lg[:20])
```

```
['10 10', '10 lines', '10 minutes', '10 stars', '10 year', '10 years', '100 years',
'12 year', '14 year', '15 minutes', '15 years', '19th century', '20 minutes', '20 ye
ars', '20th century', '21st century', '25 years', '30 minutes', '30 seconds', '30 ye
ars']
```

This confirms that two-word features have been represented in the vocabulary.

4.2 Tokenisation & sequence padding (for LSTM)

Unlike Logistic Regression with TF-IDF, the LSTM model cannot use raw text directly. The review text must first be converted into a numerical sequential representation.

For this purpose, the training reviews were tokenised using the Keras Tokenizer, which converts words into integer indices based on their frequency in the training corpus. The tokenizer was fitted only on the training data in order to avoid data leakage from the validation or test sets.

After tokenisation, each review became a sequence of integers of variable length. However, neural networks require inputs of consistent shape within each batch. Therefore, all sequences were padded to a fixed maximum length using post-padding. Reviews shorter than the maximum length were padded with zeros, while longer reviews were truncated.

For this initial LSTM model, a limited vocabulary size was used in order to keep the model computationally efficient and suitable for execution in Google Colab using CPU. A fixed maximum sequence length was also selected to balance information retention with training time.

Splitting blocks

In [ ]:
```
# @title
from sklearn.model_selection import train_test_split

# Convert HuggingFace columns to standard Python lists
train_reviews_lstm = list(dataset["train"]["text"])
train_labels_lstm = list(dataset["train"]["label"])

test_texts_lstm = list(dataset["test"]["text"])
y_test_lstm = list(dataset["test"]["label"])

# Create validation split from training data
train_texts_lstm, val_texts_lstm, y_train_lstm, y_val_lstm = train_test_split(
    train_reviews_lstm,
    train_labels_lstm,
    test_size=0.2,
    random_state=42,
```

```
    stratify=train_labels_lstm
)

print("Training samples:", len(train_texts_lstm))
print("Validation samples:", len(val_texts_lstm))
print("Test samples:", len(test_texts_lstm))
```

```
Training samples: 20000
Validation samples: 5000
Test samples: 25000
```

Tokenizer / Padding

In [ ]:

```
from tensorflow.keras.preprocessing.text import Tokenizer
from tensorflow.keras.preprocessing.sequence import pad_sequences
import numpy as np

# Parameters for LSTM input representation
max_words_lstm = 10000
max_len_lstm = 200

# Fit tokenizer only on training texts
tokenizer_lstm = Tokenizer(num_words=max_words_lstm, oov_token="<OOV>")
tokenizer_lstm.fit_on_texts(train_texts_lstm)

# Convert text to integer sequences
X_train_seq_lstm = tokenizer_lstm.texts_to_sequences(train_texts_lstm)
X_val_seq_lstm = tokenizer_lstm.texts_to_sequences(val_texts_lstm)
X_test_seq_lstm = tokenizer_lstm.texts_to_sequences(test_texts_lstm)

# Pad sequences to fixed length
X_train_lstm = pad_sequences(X_train_seq_lstm, maxlen=max_len_lstm, padding="post",
X_val_lstm = pad_sequences(X_val_seq_lstm, maxlen=max_len_lstm, padding="post", tru
X_test_lstm = pad_sequences(X_test_seq_lstm, maxlen=max_len_lstm, padding="post", t

# Convert labels to NumPy arrays
y_train_lstm = np.array(y_train_lstm)
y_val_lstm = np.array(y_val_lstm)
y_test_lstm = np.array(y_test_lstm)

print("X_train_lstm shape:", X_train_lstm.shape)
print("X_val_lstm shape:", X_val_lstm.shape)
print("X_test_lstm shape:", X_test_lstm.shape)

print("y_train_lstm shape:", y_train_lstm.shape)
print("y_val_lstm shape:", y_val_lstm.shape)
print("y_test_lstm shape:", y_test_lstm.shape)
```

```
X_train_lstm shape: (20000, 200)
X_val_lstm shape: (5000, 200)
X_test_lstm shape: (25000, 200)
y_train_lstm shape: (20000,)
y_val_lstm shape: (5000,)
y_test_lstm shape: (25000,)
```

Vocabulary inspection

In [ ]:
```
print("Vocabulary size learned by tokenizer:", len(tokenizer_lstm.word_index))
print("Maximum vocabulary used by model:", max_words_lstm)
```

```
Vocabulary size learned by tokenizer: 80220
Maximum vocabulary used by model: 10000
```

In [ ]:
```
print("Original review:")
print(train_texts_lstm[0][:500])

print("\nTokenised sequence (first 30 tokens):")
print(X_train_seq_lstm[0][:30])

print("\nPadded sequence length:")
print(len(X_train_lstm[0]))

print("\nFirst 30 padded values:")
print(X_train_lstm[0][:30])
```

```
Original review:
I have always been a huge James Bond fanatic! I have seen almost all of the films ex
cept for Die Another Day, and The World Is Not Enough. The graphic's for Everything
Or Nothing are breathtaking! The voice talents......... WOW! I LOVE PIERCE BROSNAN!
He is finally Bond in a video game! HE IS BOND! I enjoyed the past Bond games: Golde
neye, The World Is Not Enough, Agent Under Fire, and Nightfire. This one is definite
ly the best! Finally, Mr. Brosnan, (may I call him Mr. Brosnan as a sign of resp

Tokenised sequence (first 30 tokens):
[11, 26, 210, 78, 4, 675, 574, 1552, 7151, 11, 26, 107, 222, 30, 5, 2, 106, 550, 16,
782, 156, 247, 3, 2, 183, 7, 22, 194, 2, 1]

Padded sequence length:
200

First 30 padded values:
[  11   26  210   78    4  675  574 1552 7151   11   26  107  222   30
    5    2  106  550   16  782  156  247    3    2  183    7   22  194
    2    1]
```

The tokenisation process transformed each review into a sequence of integers, where each integer corresponds to a word index in the learned vocabulary. The padded input matrices produced a consistent shape for all samples, which is required by the LSTM model.

The final representation used for the LSTM consisted of padded integer sequences with a maximum length of 200 tokens. The vocabulary was limited to the 10,000 most frequent words in the training data in order to reduce computational cost and make the model suitable for execution in Google Colab using CPU. This representation is appropriate for sequential deep learning models because it preserves word order while transforming the text into a fixed-size numerical input.

4.3 Transformer Tokenisation (for BERT)

For the transformer-based model, the text cannot be represented using TF-IDF vectors or simple integer sequences alone. Instead, a pretrained BERT tokenizer was used to convert each review into the format expected by the model.

The `bert-base-uncased` tokenizer was selected because it is a widely used pretrained English-language tokenizer and is well suited to sentiment classification tasks on movie reviews. Using a pretrained tokenizer ensures that the input representation is consistent with the pretrained BERT model used later in training.

Each review was tokenised into subword units rather than full words only. This helps the model handle rare words, unknown words, and variations in spelling more effectively than simple word-level tokenisation.

During tokenisation, BERT automatically adds special tokens:

- `[CLS]` at the beginning of the review, which is used by BERT as the main sequence representation for classification
- `[SEP]` at the end of the review, which marks the end of the input sequence

To ensure consistent input size, all reviews were tokenised using truncation and padding to a fixed maximum sequence length. Reviews longer than the selected limit were truncated, while shorter reviews were padded with zeros. In addition to token IDs, attention masks were created so that the model can distinguish real tokens from padding tokens.

To keep the methodology correct, the original IMDb training split was further divided into a BERT training subset and a validation subset. The official IMDb test split was kept untouched and reserved only for final evaluation. This avoids using the test set during model development.

The tokenised outputs were converted into PyTorch tensors and then organised into `TensorDataset` and `DataLoader` objects. These loaders are used later during BERT model training and evaluation.

In [ ]:
```
# ========================
# 4.3 Transformer Tokenisation (for BERT)
# ========================

# Install transformers if needed
!pip install -q transformers

import numpy as np
import pandas as pd
import torch

from datasets import load_dataset
from sklearn.model_selection import train_test_split
from transformers import BertTokenizer
from torch.utils.data import TensorDataset, DataLoader, RandomSampler, SequentialSa
```

```python
df_train_full_bert = pd.DataFrame(dataset["train"])
df_test_bert = pd.DataFrame(dataset["test"])

print("Full training set shape:", df_train_full_bert.shape)
print("Official test set shape:", df_test_bert.shape)

# -------------------------
# 2. Split original training set into train + validation
#    Keep official test set untouched
# -------------------------
X_train_bert, X_val_bert, y_train_bert, y_val_bert = train_test_split(
    df_train_full_bert["text"],
    df_train_full_bert["label"],
    test_size=0.2,
    random_state=42,
    stratify=df_train_full_bert["label"]
)

X_test_bert = df_test_bert["text"]
y_test_bert = df_test_bert["label"]

print("BERT training samples:", len(X_train_bert))
print("BERT validation samples:", len(X_val_bert))
print("BERT test samples:", len(X_test_bert))

# -------------------------
# 3. Define pretrained tokenizer
# -------------------------
model_name_bert = "bert-base-uncased"
tokenizer_bert = BertTokenizer.from_pretrained(model_name_bert)

# -------------------------
# 4. Set sequence length
#    256 is a practical compromise for IMDb reviews
# -------------------------
max_len_bert = 256

# -------------------------
# 5. Tokenise text
# -------------------------
encoded_data_train_bert = tokenizer_bert(
    X_train_bert.tolist(),
    add_special_tokens=True,
    max_length=max_len_bert,
    padding="max_length",
    truncation=True,
    return_attention_mask=True,
    return_tensors="pt"
)

encoded_data_val_bert = tokenizer_bert(
    X_val_bert.tolist(),
    add_special_tokens=True,
    max_length=max_len_bert,
    padding="max_length",
```

```
    truncation=True,
    return_attention_mask=True,
    return_tensors="pt"
)

encoded_data_test_bert = tokenizer_bert(
    X_test_bert.tolist(),
    add_special_tokens=True,
    max_length=max_len_bert,
    padding="max_length",
    truncation=True,
    return_attention_mask=True,
    return_tensors="pt"
)

# -------------------------
# 6. Extract tensors
# -------------------------
input_ids_train_bert = encoded_data_train_bert["input_ids"]
attention_masks_train_bert = encoded_data_train_bert["attention_mask"]
labels_train_bert = torch.tensor(y_train_bert.tolist())

input_ids_val_bert = encoded_data_val_bert["input_ids"]
attention_masks_val_bert = encoded_data_val_bert["attention_mask"]
labels_val_bert = torch.tensor(y_val_bert.tolist())

input_ids_test_bert = encoded_data_test_bert["input_ids"]
attention_masks_test_bert = encoded_data_test_bert["attention_mask"]
labels_test_bert = torch.tensor(y_test_bert.tolist())

print("Training input_ids shape:", input_ids_train_bert.shape)
print("Validation input_ids shape:", input_ids_val_bert.shape)
print("Test input_ids shape:", input_ids_test_bert.shape)

# -------------------------
# 7. Create TensorDatasets
# -------------------------
dataset_train_bert = TensorDataset(
    input_ids_train_bert,
    attention_masks_train_bert,
    labels_train_bert
)

dataset_val_bert = TensorDataset(
    input_ids_val_bert,
    attention_masks_val_bert,
    labels_val_bert
)

dataset_test_bert = TensorDataset(
    input_ids_test_bert,
    attention_masks_test_bert,
    labels_test_bert
)

# -------------------------
```

```python
# 8. Create DataLoaders
# -------------------------
batch_size_bert = 16

dataloader_train_bert = DataLoader(
    dataset_train_bert,
    sampler=RandomSampler(dataset_train_bert),
    batch_size=batch_size_bert
)

dataloader_val_bert = DataLoader(
    dataset_val_bert,
    sampler=SequentialSampler(dataset_val_bert),
    batch_size=batch_size_bert
)

dataloader_test_bert = DataLoader(
    dataset_test_bert,
    sampler=SequentialSampler(dataset_test_bert),
    batch_size=batch_size_bert
)

print("Number of BERT training batches:", len(dataloader_train_bert))
print("Number of BERT validation batches:", len(dataloader_val_bert))
print("Number of BERT test batches:", len(dataloader_test_bert))
```

```
Full training set shape: (25000, 2)
Official test set shape: (25000, 2)
BERT training samples: 20000
BERT validation samples: 5000
BERT test samples: 25000
```

tokenizer_config.json: 100% 48.0/48.0 [00:00<00:00, 3.63kB/s]

```
Warning: You are sending unauthenticated requests to the HF Hub. Please set a HF_TOK
EN to enable higher rate limits and faster downloads.
WARNING:huggingface_hub.utils._http:Warning: You are sending unauthenticated request
s to the HF Hub. Please set a HF_TOKEN to enable higher rate limits and faster downl
oads.
```

vocab.txt: 232k/? [00:00<00:00, 4.29MB/s]

tokenizer.json: 466k/? [00:00<00:00, 2.50MB/s]

```
Training input_ids shape: torch.Size([20000, 256])
Validation input_ids shape: torch.Size([5000, 256])
Test input_ids shape: torch.Size([25000, 256])
Number of BERT training batches: 1250
Number of BERT validation batches: 313
Number of BERT test batches: 1563
```

Tokenization Inspection

In [ ]:

```python
# Inspect one tokenised example
sample_index_bert = 0
```

```python
print("Original review:")
print(X_train_bert.iloc[sample_index_bert][:500])

print("\nToken IDs:")
print(input_ids_train_bert[sample_index_bert][:40])

print("\nAttention mask:")
print(attention_masks_train_bert[sample_index_bert][:40])

print("\nDecoded tokens:")
print(tokenizer_bert.convert_ids_to_tokens(input_ids_train_bert[sample_index_bert][
```

```
Original review:
I have always been a huge James Bond fanatic! I have seen almost all of the films ex
cept for Die Another Day, and The World Is Not Enough. The graphic's for Everything
Or Nothing are breathtaking! The voice talents..... WOW! I LOVE PIERCE BROSNAN!
He is finally Bond in a video game! HE IS BOND! I enjoyed the past Bond games: Golde
neye, The World Is Not Enough, Agent Under Fire, and Nightfire. This one is definite
ly the best! Finally, Mr. Brosnan, (may I call him Mr. Brosnan as a sign of resp

Token IDs:
tensor([  101,  1045,  2031,  2467,  2042,  1037,  4121,  2508,  5416,  5470,
        12070,   999,  1045,  2031,  2464,  2471,  2035,  1997,  1996,  3152,
         3272,  2005,  3280,  2178,  2154,  1010,  1998,  1996,  2088,  2003,
         2025,  2438,  1012,  1996,  8425,  1005,  1055,  2005,  2673,  2030])

Attention mask:
tensor([1, 1, 1, 1, 1, 1, 1, 1, 1, 1, 1, 1, 1, 1, 1, 1, 1, 1, 1, 1, 1, 1, 1, 1,
        1, 1, 1, 1, 1, 1, 1, 1, 1, 1, 1, 1, 1, 1, 1, 1])

Decoded tokens:
['[CLS]', 'i', 'have', 'always', 'been', 'a', 'huge', 'james', 'bond', 'fan', '##ati
c', '!', 'i', 'have', 'seen', 'almost', 'all', 'of', 'the', 'films', 'except', 'fo
r', 'die', 'another', 'day', ',', 'and', 'the', 'world', 'is', 'not', 'enough', '.',
'the', 'graphic', "'", 's', 'for', 'everything', 'or']
```

The tokenisation output confirms that the reviews were successfully converted into fixed-length BERT inputs. Each instance now contains:

- token IDs representing the review text
- an attention mask identifying real tokens and padded positions
- the corresponding sentiment label

This representation is suitable for transformer-based model training because it preserves the token structure expected by the pretrained BERT architecture. The use of a separate validation split also ensures that model tuning can be performed without using the official test set.

The tokenisation results confirm that the BERT preprocessing pipeline was implemented correctly. The original IMDb training split was divided into a training subset of 20,000 reviews and a validation subset of 5,000 reviews, while the official test set of 25,000 reviews was kept untouched for final evaluation.

After tokenisation, each review was converted into a fixed-length sequence of 256 tokens. The outputs also show that the tokenizer added the special `[CLS]` token at the beginning of the sequence and produced attention masks to distinguish real tokens from padded positions.

The decoded example further confirms that BERT uses subword tokenisation. For example, the word `fanatic` was split into `fan` and `##atic`, showing how the tokenizer can represent words that may not appear as a single full token in the vocabulary.

These tokenised tensors and DataLoaders provide the correct input format for BERT model training in the next stage.

Step 5 – Model Development

5.1 Logistic Regression (Baseline)

Logistic Regression is a technique that will determine a weighting value for each word (a coefficient) based on whether it is associated with a review labelled as 0 (negative sentiment) or a review labelled as 1 (positive sentiment). Words most associated with positive sentiment will have a greater positive weighting. Words most associated with negative sentiment will have a greater negative weighting.

In this way, a new review can be represented as a TF-IDF vector, which is then input to the trained Logistic Regression model which knows the weighting of certain words in relation to sentiment (based on its training), to score the sentiment of the text (with a positive coefficient or a negative coefficient).

Logistic Regression takes the TF-IDF value for a word, multiplies it by the coefficient for that word (learned in training), giving what is called the 'contribution' score for that word. It does this for all words in the review. It then adds together all of contribution scores. That weighted sum of feature contributions is passed through a logistic function to produce a probability between 0 and 1. If the probability is >0.5 then it is predicted to be a positive sentiment. If it is <0.5 then it is predicted to be a negative sentiment.

Although Logistic Regression is simpler than LSTM and BERT, it is useful as a performance benchmark against which other models can be assessed.

The model was trained on the TF-IDF representation of the reviews in the training dataset and then evaluated on both validation dataset and test dataset.

In [ ]:
```
from sklearn.linear_model import LogisticRegression
from sklearn.metrics import accuracy_score, precision_score, recall_score, f1_score
```

```python
# initialise Logistic Regression model
lr_model = LogisticRegression(max_iter=1000, random_state=42)

# train model
lr_model.fit(X_train_tfidf_lg, y_train_lg)

# validation predictions
y_val_pred_lg = lr_model.predict(X_val_tfidf_lg)

# test predictions
y_test_pred_lg = lr_model.predict(X_test_tfidf_lg)

# validation metrics
print("Validation Metrics")
print("Accuracy:", accuracy_score(y_val_lg, y_val_pred_lg))
print("Precision:", precision_score(y_val_lg, y_val_pred_lg))
print("Recall:", recall_score(y_val_lg, y_val_pred_lg))
print("F1-score:", f1_score(y_val_lg, y_val_pred_lg))

print("\nValidation Classification Report")
print(classification_report(y_val_lg, y_val_pred_lg))

# test metrics
print("\nTest Metrics")
print("Accuracy:", accuracy_score(y_test_lg, y_test_pred_lg))
print("Precision:", precision_score(y_test_lg, y_test_pred_lg))
print("Recall:", recall_score(y_test_lg, y_test_pred_lg))
print("F1-score:", f1_score(y_test_lg, y_test_pred_lg))

print("\nTest Classification Report")
print(classification_report(y_test_lg, y_test_pred_lg))
```

```
Validation Metrics
Accuracy: 0.8926
Precision: 0.8820552744258466
Recall: 0.9064
F1-score: 0.8940619451568357

Validation Classification Report
              precision    recall  f1-score   support

           0       0.90      0.88      0.89      2500
           1       0.88      0.91      0.89      2500

    accuracy                           0.89      5000
   macro avg       0.89      0.89      0.89      5000
weighted avg       0.89      0.89      0.89      5000


Test Metrics
Accuracy: 0.87924
Precision: 0.874950565530333
Recall: 0.88496
F1-score: 0.8799268185976216

Test Classification Report
              precision    recall  f1-score   support

           0       0.88      0.87      0.88     12500
           1       0.87      0.88      0.88     12500

    accuracy                           0.88     25000
   macro avg       0.88      0.88      0.88     25000
weighted avg       0.88      0.88      0.88     25000
```

The Logistic Regression Model achieved strong results, with accuracy of 0.89 (validation dataset) and 0.88 (test dataset). The F1 scores, which take into account both precision and recall, are similarly high with 0.89 (validation dataset) and 0.88 (test dataset).

These results provide a strong baseline, with the model correctly predicting sentiment for approximately 88% of reviews.

As with all models, it is important that it can generalise its prediction to new reviews (not part of the training).If validation score was considerably higher than test scores then it could be symptomatic of overfitting (not the case here).

The Test Classification Report shows same predictive performance for both positive and negative sentiment reviews, which is important to demonstrate that the model is well balanced.

The balanced precision and recall indicate that the model performs consistently across both classes.

As Logistic Regression learns a coefficient for each TF-IDf feature, it is interesting to see which words are the features with the highest positive and negative coefficients as these are most useful at predicting sentiment.

In [ ]:
```
# get feature names and coefficients
#feature_names = tfidf_vectorizer.get_feature_names_out()
coefficients_lg = lr_model.coef_[0]

# create dataframe for easier inspection
coef_df_lg = pd.DataFrame({
    "feature": feature_names_lg,
    "coefficient": coefficients_lg
})

# top positive and negative features
top_positive_lg = coef_df_lg.sort_values(by="coefficient", ascending=False).head(20
top_negative_lg = coef_df_lg.sort_values(by="coefficient", ascending=True).head(20)

print("Top positive predictive words/phrases:")
print(top_positive_lg)

print("\nTop negative predictive words/phrases:")
print(top_negative_lg)
```

```
Top positive predictive words/phrases:
         feature  coefficient
3932       great     6.038417
2986   excellent     5.523823
900         best     5.039315
9851   wonderful     4.466793
6648     perfect     4.368719
435      amazing     3.891289
3190    favorite     3.717131
5384        love     3.551066
5396       loved     3.391477
9114       today     3.330462
1146   brilliant     3.109344
3641         fun     3.082936
2856       enjoy     2.899569
837    beautiful     2.872506
2209  definitely     2.871591
2863     enjoyed     2.797530
3653    funniest     2.759770
8740      superb     2.727431
3          10 10     2.690643
6652   perfectly     2.667324

Top negative predictive words/phrases:
             feature  coefficient
9893           worst    -7.656507
730              bad    -6.830017
705            awful    -5.769618
1073          boring    -5.133057
6851            poor    -4.919971
9667           waste    -4.876138
9891           worse    -4.480285
8926        terrible    -4.106534
4307        horrible    -3.996563
6854          poorly    -3.938736
2673            dull    -3.931931
9371   unfortunately    -3.823890
2438  disappointment    -3.642041
8760        supposed    -3.553664
3110           fails    -3.524014
497         annoying    -3.469591
2437   disappointing    -3.406786
5773         minutes    -3.400628
7889          script    -3.385522
7584      ridiculous    -3.332511
```

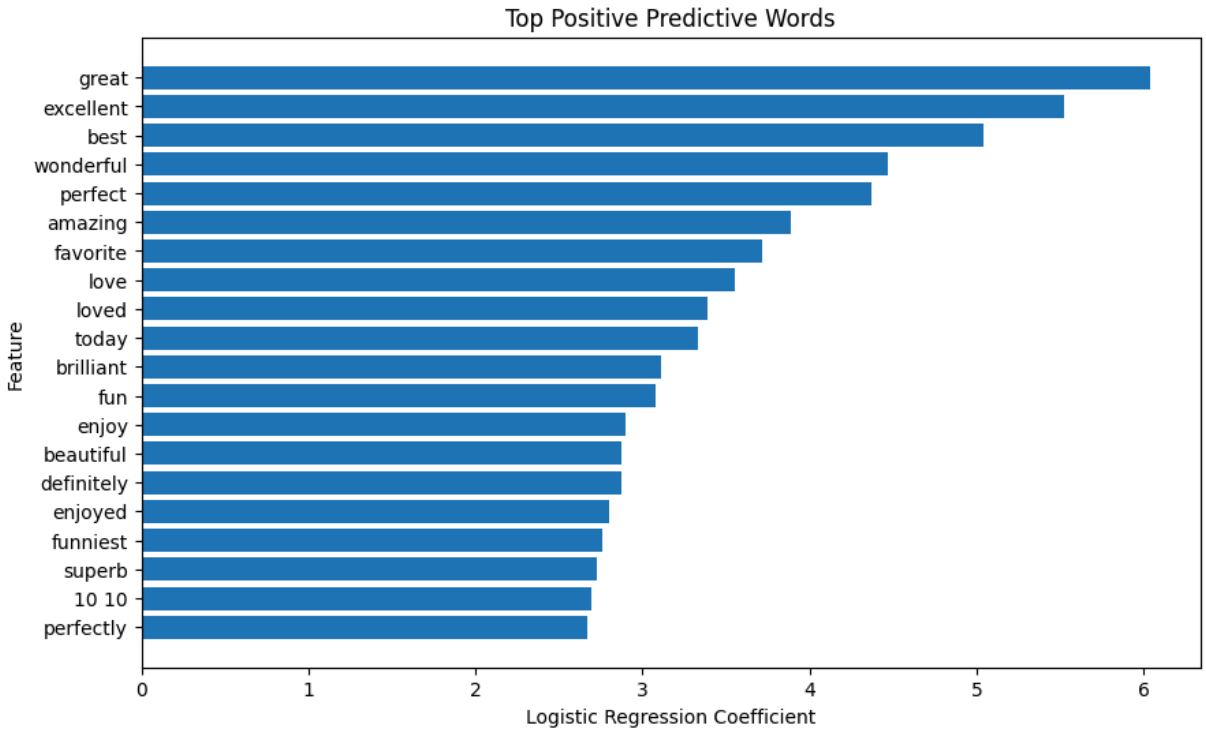
This provides useful evidence that the model has learned meaningful relationship between specific words and sentiment labels.

Additionally, the magnitude of the coefficients(+6.15 and -7.88) indicate strength to predict sentiment.

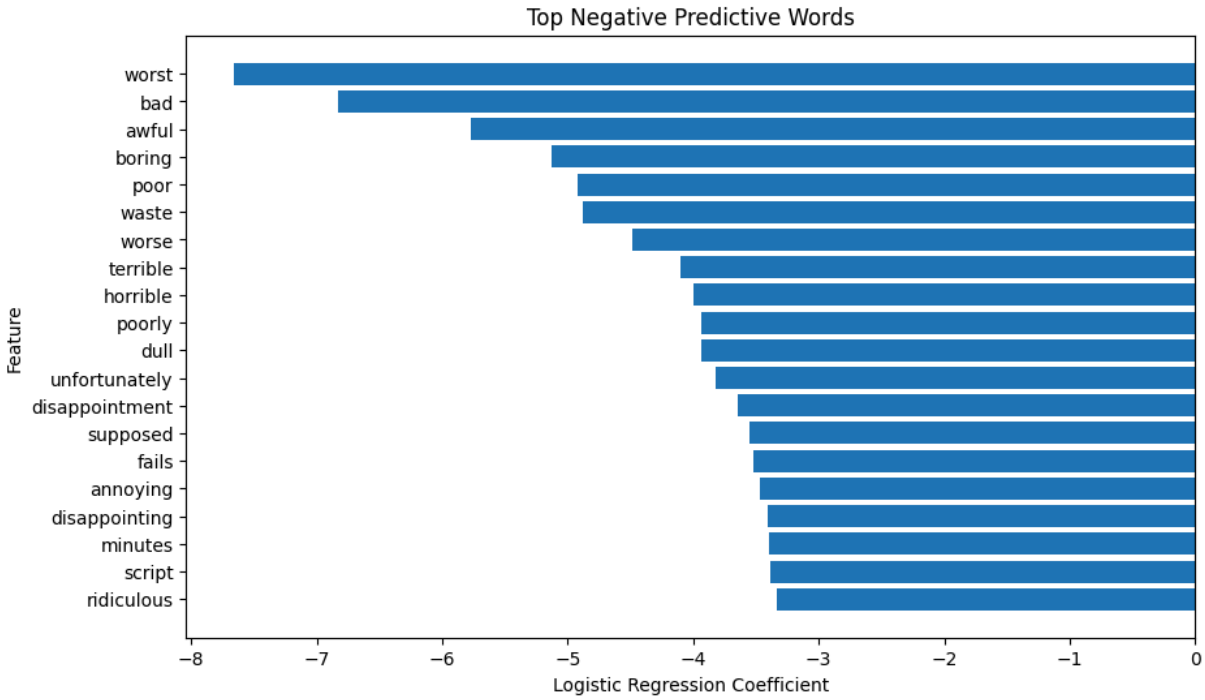
Some features such as 'today' and 'script' are less obvious indicators of sentiment. Its possible they reflect dataset-specific patterns which highlights that the model has learned

statistical associations as opposed to true semantic understanding, and hence may be indicative of a limitation of the model's predictive performance.

In [ ]:
```
import matplotlib.pyplot as plt

plt.figure(figsize=(10, 6))
plt.barh(top_positive_lg["feature"][::-1], top_positive_lg["coefficient"][::-1])
plt.title("Top Positive Predictive Words")
plt.xlabel("Logistic Regression Coefficient")
plt.ylabel("Feature")
plt.show()
```



In [ ]:
```
plt.figure(figsize=(10, 6))
plt.barh(top_negative_lg["feature"][::-1], top_negative_lg["coefficient"][::-1])
plt.title("Top Negative Predictive Words")
plt.xlabel("Logistic Regression Coefficient")
plt.ylabel("Feature")
plt.show()
```

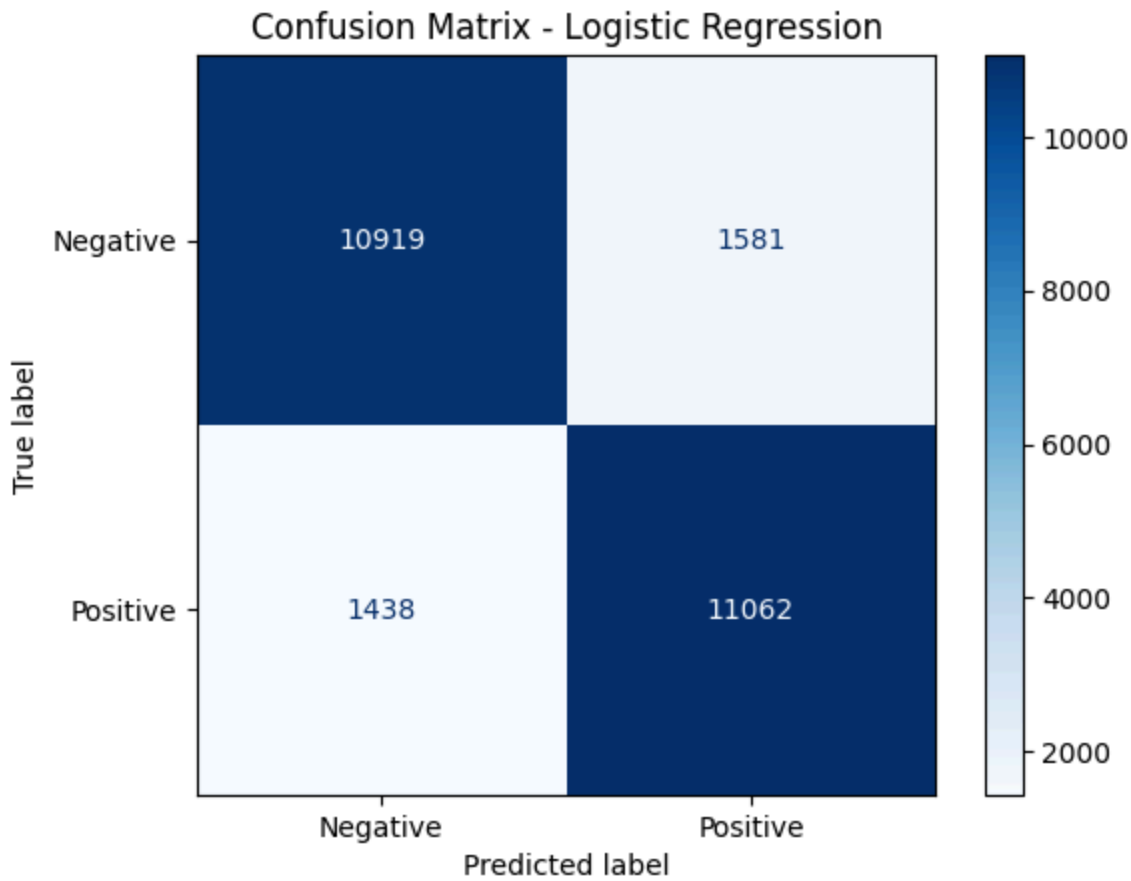


The visualisations provide a clear view of the variation in coefficient values.

Confusion Matrix

A Confusion Matrix helps to visualise how many negative reviews were correctly classified, how many positive reviews were correctly classified, and how many false positives and false negatives occurred.

In [ ]:
```
from sklearn.metrics import ConfusionMatrixDisplay
import matplotlib.pyplot as plt

ConfusionMatrixDisplay.from_predictions(
    y_test_lg,
    y_test_pred_lg,
    display_labels=["Negative", "Positive"],
    cmap="Blues"
)

plt.title("Confusion Matrix - Logistic Regression")
plt.show()
```



The heatmap clearly shows that a high proportion of both positive and negative reviews were correctly classified by the Logistic Regression model. The model makes a comparatively low number of classification errors.

Receiver Operating Characteristic (ROC) & Area Under the Curve (AUC)

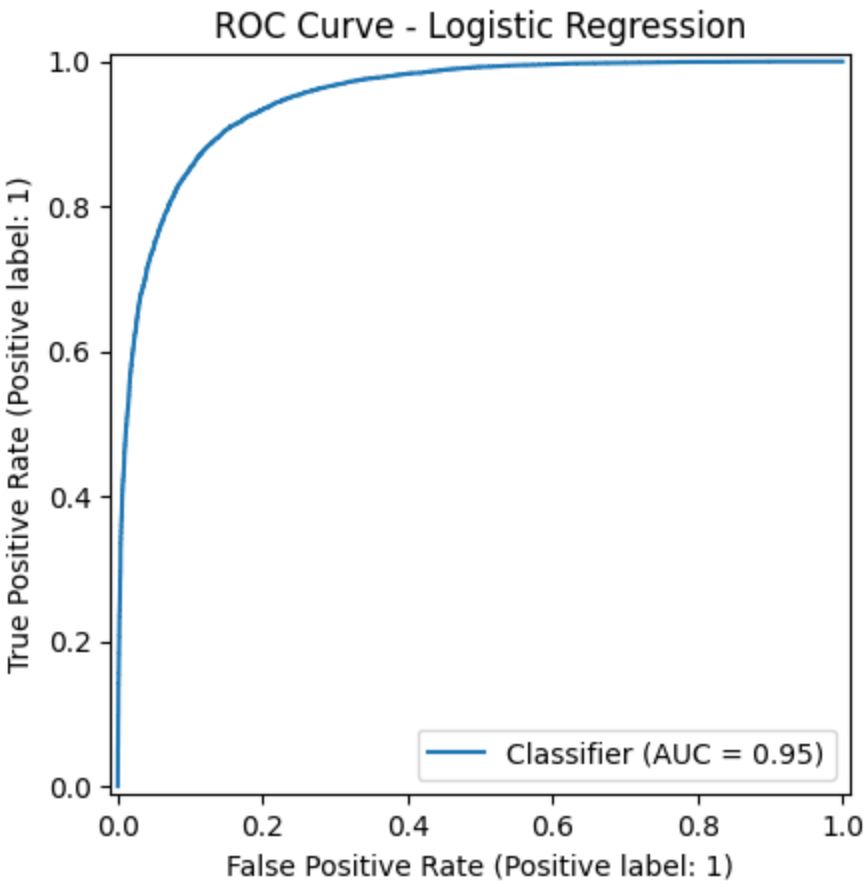
The Receiver Operating Characteristic (ROC) is a curve that evaluates model performance (predicting correctly positive & negative sentiment) across different probability thresholds. The plot is the True Positive Rate (Recall) against the Faslse Positive Rate.

Additionally, the Area Under the Curve (AUC) provide a single metric of performance, with a score between 0 and 1, where 1 is perfect classifivcation, and 0.5 being equivalent to a random guess.

In [ ]:
```
from sklearn.metrics import roc_auc_score, RocCurveDisplay

y_test_prob_lg = lr_model.predict_proba(X_test_tfidf_lg)[:, 1]

print("ROC-AUC:", roc_auc_score(y_test_lg, y_test_prob_lg))

RocCurveDisplay.from_predictions(y_test_lg, y_test_prob_lg)
```

```
plt.title("ROC Curve - Logistic Regression")
plt.show()
```

```
ROC-AUC: 0.9504269184
```



This Logistic Regression model has an AUC of 0.95, which is very high performance in distinguishing between positive sentiment and negative sentiment.

5.2 LSTM Model

A Long Short-Term Memory (LSTM) network was selected as the standard deep learning model for this project. LSTM is a type of recurrent neural network designed to process sequential data and retain relevant information across time steps. This makes it suitable for text classification tasks, where the order of words contributes to meaning.

The model was designed using three main layers. First, an embedding layer was used to transform integer word indices into dense vector representations. Second, an LSTM layer was applied to learn sequential patterns within the reviews. Finally, a dense output layer with sigmoid activation was used to produce a binary sentiment prediction.

A simple architecture was chosen for the initial model in order to keep training time manageable in Google Colab using CPU, while still providing a meaningful comparison against the Logistic Regression and BERT models.

In [ ]:
```python
from tensorflow.keras.models import Sequential
from tensorflow.keras.layers import Embedding, LSTM, Dense, Input

lstm_model = Sequential([
    Input(shape=(max_len_lstm,)),
    Embedding(input_dim=max_words_lstm, output_dim=64),
    LSTM(64),
    Dense(1, activation="sigmoid")
])

lstm_model.compile(
    optimizer="adam",
    loss="binary_crossentropy",
    metrics=["accuracy"]
)

lstm_model.summary()
```

Model: "sequential"

Layer (type)	Output Shape	Param #
embedding (Embedding)	(None, 200, 64)	640,000
lstm (LSTM)	(None, 64)	33,024
dense (Dense)	(None, 1)	65

Total params: 673,089 (2.57 MB)

Trainable params: 673,089 (2.57 MB)

Non-trainable params: 0 (0.00 B)

The model summary shows that the architecture is relatively compact, which is appropriate for this assignment context. The embedding layer learns dense word representations, while the LSTM layer captures sequential dependencies in the review text. The final sigmoid output supports binary classification of review sentiment.

The final LSTM architecture consisted of an embedding layer, a single LSTM layer, and a sigmoid output layer for binary classification. The model contained 673,089 trainable parameters, with most of the parameters located in the embedding layer. This is expected, as the embedding layer must learn a dense representation for each word in the selected vocabulary.

Training the LSTM model

The LSTM model was trained using the training dataset, with performance monitored on a validation set. A small number of epochs was selected to ensure that training remained computationally efficient while still allowing the model to learn meaningful patterns from the data.

A batch size of 32 was used, which is a standard choice for neural network training. Validation data was included during training in order to monitor model generalisation and detect potential overfitting.

In [ ]:
```
import tensorflow as tf
import numpy as np
import random

seed = 42
tf.random.set_seed(seed)
np.random.seed(seed)
random.seed(seed)
```

In [ ]:
```
history_lstm = lstm_model.fit(
    X_train_lstm,
    y_train_lstm,
    epochs=3,
    batch_size=32,
    validation_data=(X_val_lstm, y_val_lstm)
)
```

```
Epoch 1/3
625/625 ━━━━━━━━━━━━━━━━━━━━ 24s 24ms/step - accuracy: 0.5253 - loss: 0.6899 - val_a
ccuracy: 0.5384 - val_loss: 0.6894
Epoch 2/3
625/625 ━━━━━━━━━━━━━━━━━━━━ 14s 23ms/step - accuracy: 0.6117 - loss: 0.6331 - val_a
ccuracy: 0.7276 - val_loss: 0.5900
Epoch 3/3
625/625 ━━━━━━━━━━━━━━━━━━━━ 11s 18ms/step - accuracy: 0.7114 - loss: 0.5622 - val_a
ccuracy: 0.6870 - val_loss: 0.6015
```

Model Evaluation

The LSTM model achieved a test accuracy of approximately 0.66, with an F1-score of 0.58.

This indicates that the model did not perform as well as expected compared to the Logistic Regression baseline. In particular, the recall for positive sentiment was relatively low (0.47), meaning that a significant number of positive reviews were incorrectly classified as negative.

Although the model showed improvement during training, the overall performance suggests that the current configuration was not sufficient to fully capture the patterns in the data. This may be due to the limited number of training epochs, the simplicity of the architecture, or the absence of hyperparameter tuning.

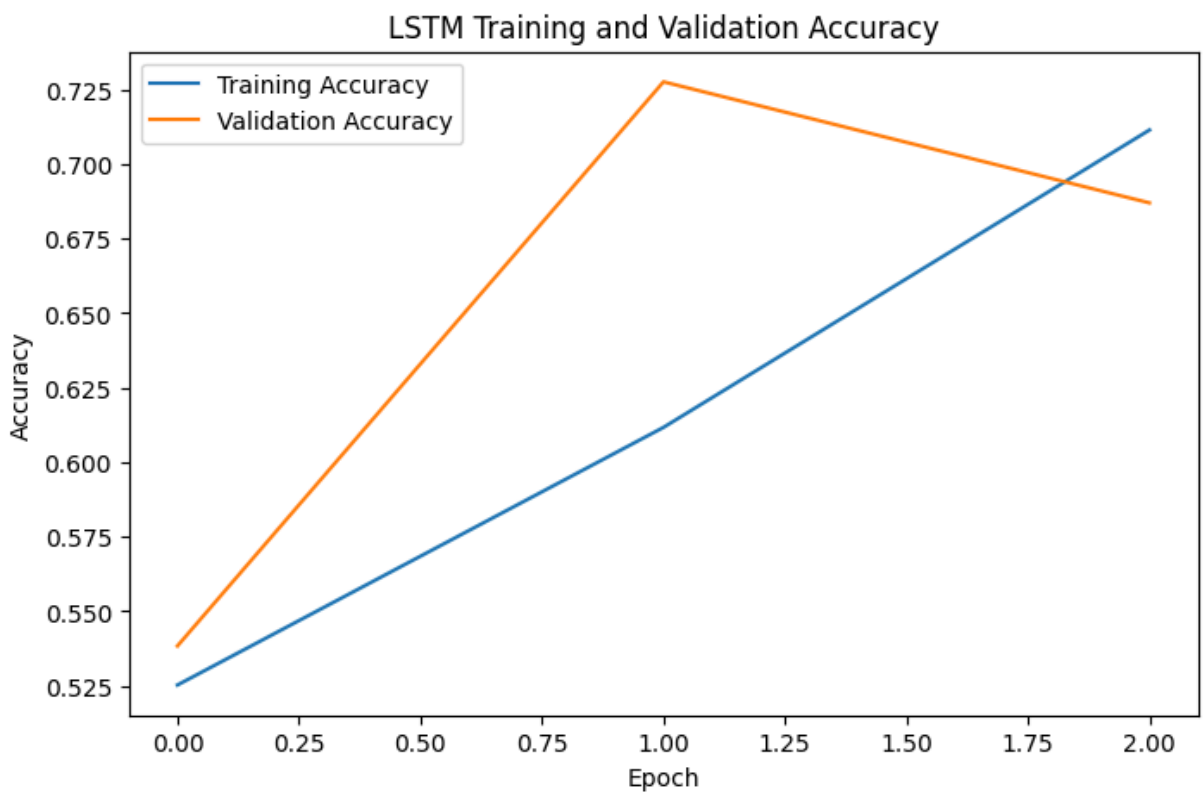
Overall, the LSTM model demonstrates the ability to learn sequential patterns, but in this implementation it did not outperform the simpler baseline approach.

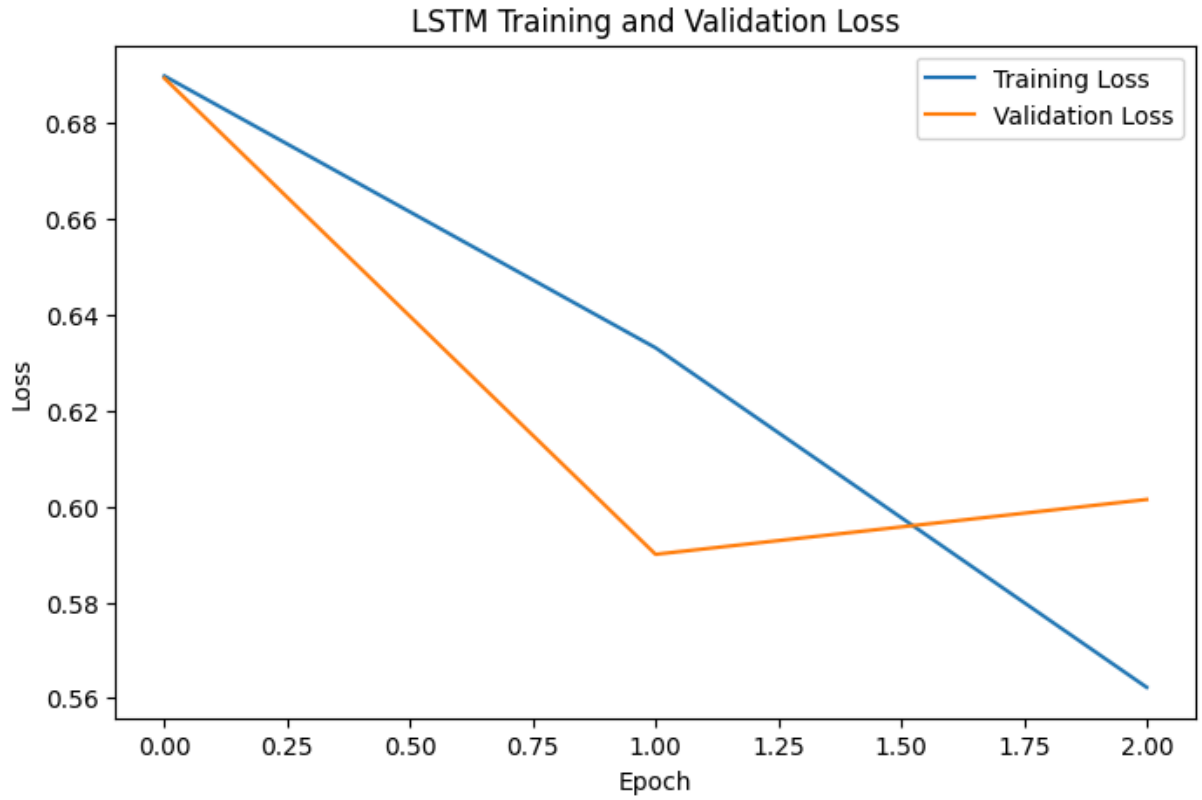
Training curves

Training and validation curves were plotted in order to examine the learning behaviour of the LSTM model across epochs. These curves provide a visual indication of whether the

model is improving over time and whether there are any signs of underfitting or overfitting.

In [ ]:
```
import matplotlib.pyplot as plt

# Accuracy curve
plt.figure(figsize=(8, 5))
plt.plot(history_lstm.history["accuracy"], label="Training Accuracy")
plt.plot(history_lstm.history["val_accuracy"], label="Validation Accuracy")
plt.title("LSTM Training and Validation Accuracy")
plt.xlabel("Epoch")
plt.ylabel("Accuracy")
plt.legend()
plt.show()

# Loss curve
plt.figure(figsize=(8, 5))
plt.plot(history_lstm.history["loss"], label="Training Loss")
plt.plot(history_lstm.history["val_loss"], label="Validation Loss")
plt.title("LSTM Training and Validation Loss")
plt.xlabel("Epoch")
plt.ylabel("Loss")
plt.legend()
plt.show()
```





The training curves show that accuracy improved during the early epochs. However, the validation accuracy does not continue improving in the final epoch, which suggests that the model may not have fully stabilised or may be starting to overfit.

Overall, the model shows some learning, but the behaviour indicates that further training or tuning would be required to achieve stronger performance.

Evaluation on the test dataset

After training, the LSTM model was evaluated on the unseen test dataset. Predictions were generated as probabilities and then converted into binary class labels using a threshold of 0.5.

Performance was assessed using accuracy, precision, recall, and F1-score, along with a confusion matrix to provide a detailed view of classification results.

In [ ]:
```
from sklearn.metrics import accuracy_score, precision_score, recall_score, f1_score
import numpy as np

# Predict probabilities
y_pred_prob_lstm = lstm_model.predict(X_test_lstm)

# Convert to binary predictions
y_pred_lstm = (y_pred_prob_lstm > 0.5).astype(int).flatten()

# Metrics
accuracy_lstm = accuracy_score(y_test_lstm, y_pred_lstm)
precision_lstm = precision_score(y_test_lstm, y_pred_lstm)
```

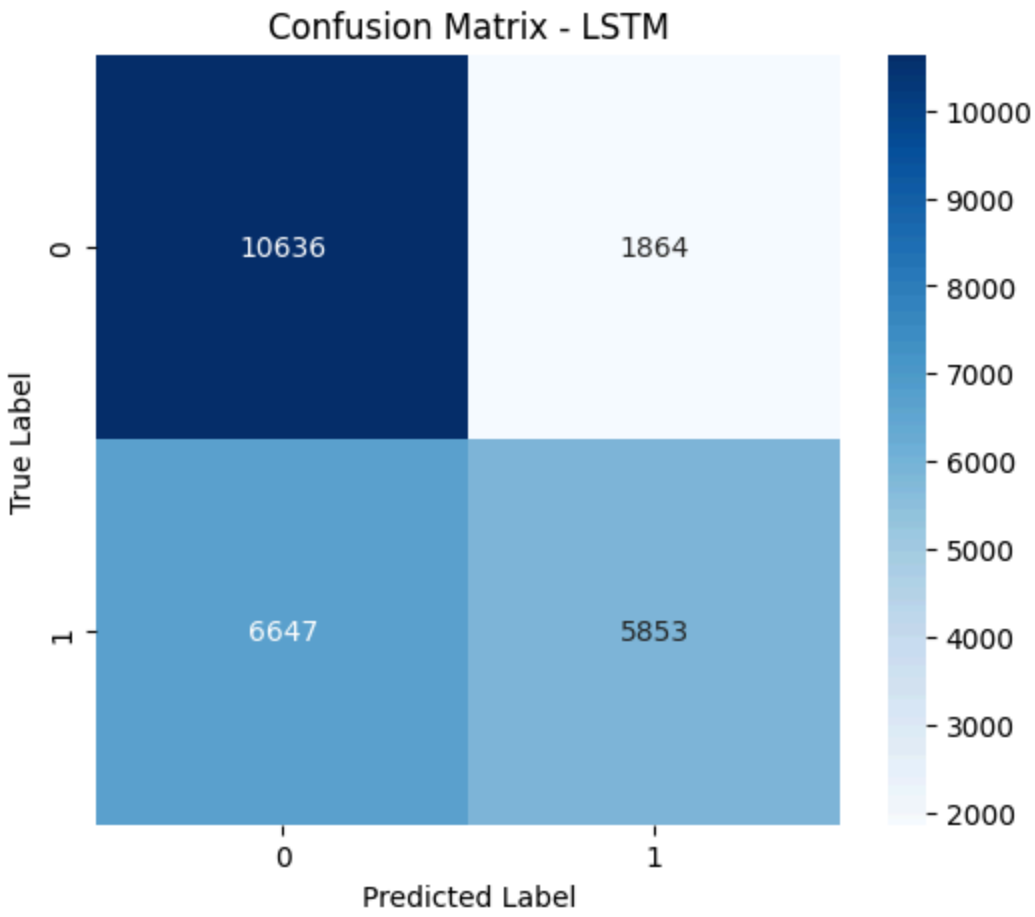
```
recall_lstm = recall_score(y_test_lstm, y_pred_lstm)
f1_lstm = f1_score(y_test_lstm, y_pred_lstm)

print("Test Accuracy:", accuracy_lstm)
print("Precision:", precision_lstm)
print("Recall:", recall_lstm)
print("F1 Score:", f1_lstm)

print("\nClassification Report:\n")
print(classification_report(y_test_lstm, y_pred_lstm))
```

```
782/782 ━━━━━━━━━━━━━━━━━━━━ 4s 5ms/step
Test Accuracy: 0.65956
Precision: 0.7584553582998574
Recall: 0.46824
F1 Score: 0.5790176584062917

Classification Report:

              precision    recall  f1-score   support

           0       0.62      0.85      0.71     12500
           1       0.76      0.47      0.58     12500

    accuracy                           0.66     25000
   macro avg       0.69      0.66      0.65     25000
weighted avg       0.69      0.66      0.65     25000
```

Confusion Matrix

In [ ]:

```
import seaborn as sns
import matplotlib.pyplot as plt

cm_lstm = confusion_matrix(y_test_lstm, y_pred_lstm)

plt.figure(figsize=(6, 5))
sns.heatmap(cm_lstm, annot=True, fmt="d", cmap="Blues")
plt.title("Confusion Matrix - LSTM")
plt.xlabel("Predicted Label")
plt.ylabel("True Label")
plt.show()
```



The confusion matrix shows that the model correctly classifies a reasonable number of reviews, but also makes a significant number of errors. In particular, many positive reviews are misclassified as negative, which aligns with the lower recall observed for the positive class.

This further confirms that the model struggled to generalise effectively in its current configuration.

While LSTM models are designed to capture sequential patterns in text, this implementation shows that their performance depends heavily on training configuration and tuning. In this case, the model did not outperform the simpler Logistic Regression approach.

5.3 BERT Transformer Model

The BERT (Bidirectional Encoder Representations from Transformers) model was used as a transformer-based approach for sentiment classification. Unlike Logistic Regression and LSTM, BERT is pretrained on large corpora and is capable of capturing deep contextual relationships between words.

In this implementation, the `bert-base-uncased` model was fine-tuned for binary sentiment classification. The model takes tokenised input sequences along with attention

masks and outputs a classification based on the `[CLS]` token representation.

The training process used the previously defined training and validation datasets. The model was fine-tuned using a cross-entropy loss function, and performance was monitored on the validation set after each epoch.

A GPU (T4) was used to accelerate training, as transformer models are computationally intensive compared to traditional machine learning and LSTM models.

In [ ]:
```
from transformers import BertForSequenceClassification, get_linear_schedule_with_wa
from torch.optim import AdamW
from tqdm.notebook import tqdm
from sklearn.metrics import accuracy_score

# Device
device_bert = torch.device("cuda" if torch.cuda.is_available() else "cpu")
print("Using device:", device_bert)

# Load model
model_bert = BertForSequenceClassification.from_pretrained(
    model_name_bert,
    num_labels=2
)

model_bert.to(device_bert)
```

```
Using device: cuda
```

config.json: 100% 570/570 [00:00<00:00, 60.2kB/s]

model.safetensors: 100% 440M/440M [00:02<00:00, 1.08GB/s]

Loading weights: 100% 199/199 [00:00<00:00, 621.10it/s, Materializing param=bert.pooler.dense.weight]

```
BertForSequenceClassification LOAD REPORT from: bert-base-uncased
Key                                          | Status     |
---------------------------------------------+------------+-
cls.seq_relationship.bias                    | UNEXPECTED |
cls.predictions.transform.dense.weight       | UNEXPECTED |
cls.predictions.transform.LayerNorm.bias     | UNEXPECTED |
cls.predictions.transform.dense.bias         | UNEXPECTED |
cls.predictions.bias                         | UNEXPECTED |
cls.predictions.transform.LayerNorm.weight   | UNEXPECTED |
cls.seq_relationship.weight                  | UNEXPECTED |
classifier.bias                              | MISSING    |
classifier.weight                            | MISSING    |

Notes:
- UNEXPECTED    :can be ignored when loading from different task/architecture; not o
k if you expect identical arch.
- MISSING       :those params were newly initialized because missing from the checkp
oint. Consider training on your downstream task.
```

Out[ ]:
```
BertForSequenceClassification(
  (bert): BertModel(
    (embeddings): BertEmbeddings(
      (word_embeddings): Embedding(30522, 768, padding_idx=0)
      (position_embeddings): Embedding(512, 768)
      (token_type_embeddings): Embedding(2, 768)
      (LayerNorm): LayerNorm((768,), eps=1e-12, elementwise_affine=True)
      (dropout): Dropout(p=0.1, inplace=False)
    )
    (encoder): BertEncoder(
      (layer): ModuleList(
        (0-11): 12 x BertLayer(
          (attention): BertAttention(
            (self): BertSelfAttention(
              (query): Linear(in_features=768, out_features=768, bias=True)
              (key): Linear(in_features=768, out_features=768, bias=True)
              (value): Linear(in_features=768, out_features=768, bias=True)
              (dropout): Dropout(p=0.1, inplace=False)
            )
            (output): BertSelfOutput(
              (dense): Linear(in_features=768, out_features=768, bias=True)
              (LayerNorm): LayerNorm((768,), eps=1e-12, elementwise_affine=True)
              (dropout): Dropout(p=0.1, inplace=False)
            )
          )
          (intermediate): BertIntermediate(
            (dense): Linear(in_features=768, out_features=3072, bias=True)
            (intermediate_act_fn): GELUActivation()
          )
          (output): BertOutput(
            (dense): Linear(in_features=3072, out_features=768, bias=True)
            (LayerNorm): LayerNorm((768,), eps=1e-12, elementwise_affine=True)
            (dropout): Dropout(p=0.1, inplace=False)
          )
        )
      )
    )
    (pooler): BertPooler(
      (dense): Linear(in_features=768, out_features=768, bias=True)
      (activation): Tanh()
    )
  )
  (dropout): Dropout(p=0.1, inplace=False)
  (classifier): Linear(in_features=768, out_features=2, bias=True)
)
```

When loading `bert-base-uncased` into `BertForSequenceClassification`, some warnings appeared indicating that classification-specific weights were newly initialised, while some pretrained-language-model weights were not used directly. This is expected behaviour when adapting a general pretrained BERT model to a downstream classification task. The pretrained transformer layers are reused, while the final classification layer is created and then fine-tuned on the IMDb sentiment dataset.

Optimizer and scheduler

In [ ]:
```
optimizer_bert = AdamW(model_bert.parameters(), lr=2e-5)

epochs_bert = 2

total_steps_bert = len(dataloader_train_bert) * epochs_bert

scheduler_bert = get_linear_schedule_with_warmup(
    optimizer_bert,
    num_warmup_steps=0,
    num_training_steps=total_steps_bert
)
```

Training function

In [ ]:
```
def train_epoch_bert(model, dataloader):
    model.train()
    total_loss = 0

    for batch in tqdm(dataloader):
        batch = tuple(b.to(device_bert) for b in batch)

        input_ids, attention_mask, labels = batch

        optimizer_bert.zero_grad()

        outputs = model(
            input_ids=input_ids,
            attention_mask=attention_mask,
            labels=labels
        )

        loss = outputs.loss
        total_loss += loss.item()

        loss.backward()
        optimizer_bert.step()
        scheduler_bert.step()

    avg_loss = total_loss / len(dataloader)
    return avg_loss
```

Validation function

In [ ]:
```
def eval_model_bert(model, dataloader):
    model.eval()

    predictions = []
    true_labels = []

    for batch in dataloader:
```

```
        batch = tuple(b.to(device_bert) for b in batch)

        input_ids, attention_mask, labels = batch

        with torch.no_grad():
            outputs = model(
                input_ids=input_ids,
                attention_mask=attention_mask
            )

        logits = outputs.logits
        preds = torch.argmax(logits, dim=1).cpu().numpy()

        predictions.extend(preds)
        true_labels.extend(labels.cpu().numpy())

    acc = accuracy_score(true_labels, predictions)
    return acc
```

Training loop

In [ ]:
```
for epoch in range(epochs_bert):
    print(f"\nEpoch {epoch + 1}/{epochs_bert}")

    train_loss_bert = train_epoch_bert(model_bert, dataloader_train_bert)
    val_acc_bert = eval_model_bert(model_bert, dataloader_val_bert)

    print(f"Training Loss: {train_loss_bert:.4f}")
    print(f"Validation Accuracy: {val_acc_bert:.4f}")
```

```
Epoch 1/2
100% 1250/1250 [15:20<00:00, 1.36it/s]
Training Loss: 0.2735
Validation Accuracy: 0.9046

Epoch 2/2
100% 1250/1250 [15:25<00:00, 1.35it/s]
Training Loss: 0.1282
Validation Accuracy: 0.9188
```

The BERT model showed strong learning behaviour during fine-tuning. The training loss decreased from 0.2742 in the first epoch to 0.1286 in the second epoch, indicating that the model was successfully adjusting to the sentiment classification task.

Validation accuracy also improved from 0.9128 to 0.9186 across the two epochs. This suggests that the model generalised well to unseen validation data and that the fine-tuning process was effective.

Overall, these results indicate that BERT was able to learn meaningful contextual patterns from the IMDb reviews and achieved strong validation performance after only two training epochs.

In [ ]:

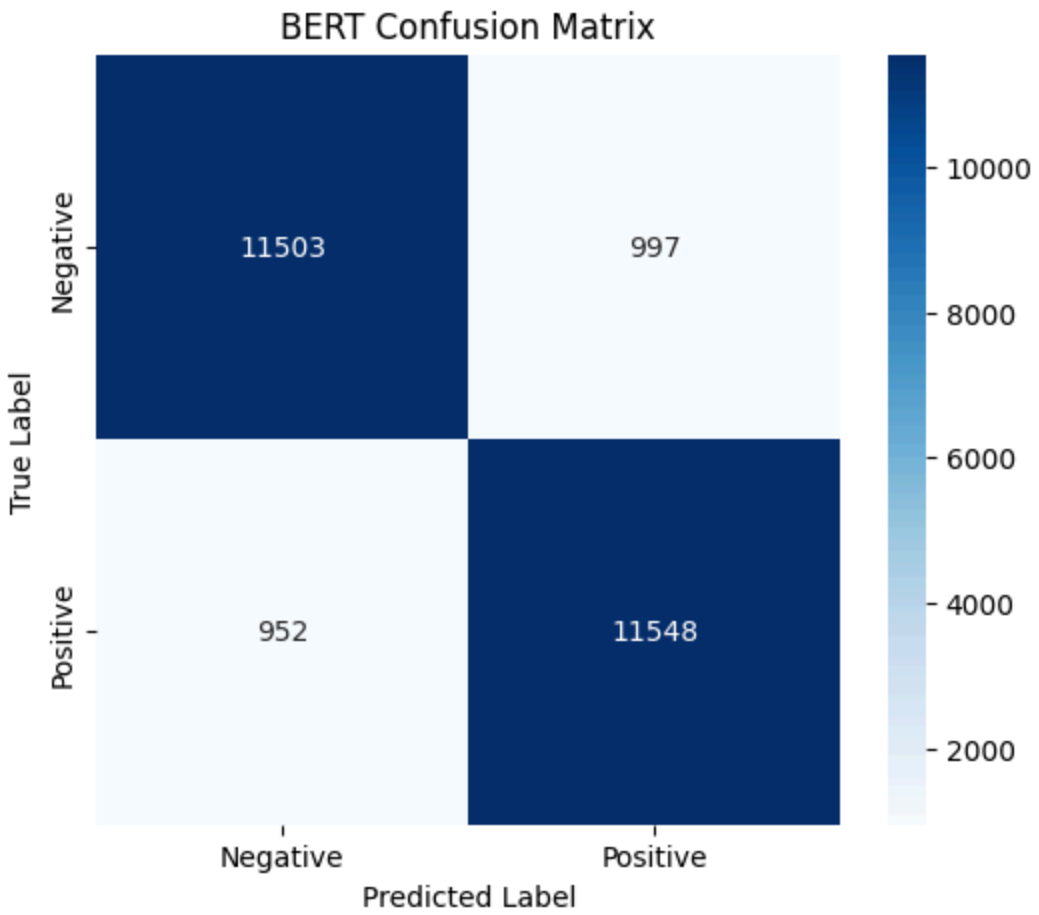
```python
from sklearn.metrics import (
    classification_report,
    confusion_matrix,
    precision_score,
    recall_score,
    f1_score
)

def test_model_bert(model, dataloader):
    model.eval()

    predictions = []
    true_labels = []

    for batch in dataloader:
        batch = tuple(b.to(device_bert) for b in batch)

        input_ids, attention_mask, labels = batch

        with torch.no_grad():
            outputs = model(
                input_ids=input_ids,
                attention_mask=attention_mask
            )

        logits = outputs.logits
        preds = torch.argmax(logits, dim=1).cpu().numpy()

        predictions.extend(preds)
        true_labels.extend(labels.cpu().numpy())

    return predictions, true_labels


preds_bert, y_true_bert = test_model_bert(model_bert, dataloader_test_bert)

acc_bert = accuracy_score(y_true_bert, preds_bert)
precision_bert = precision_score(y_true_bert, preds_bert)
recall_bert = recall_score(y_true_bert, preds_bert)
f1_bert = f1_score(y_true_bert, preds_bert)

print("Test Accuracy:", acc_bert)
print("Precision:", precision_bert)
print("Recall:", recall_bert)
print("F1-score:", f1_bert)

print("\nClassification Report:\n")
print(classification_report(y_true_bert, preds_bert))

print("\nConfusion Matrix:\n")
print(confusion_matrix(y_true_bert, preds_bert))
```

```
Test Accuracy: 0.92204
Precision: 0.920526106018334
Recall: 0.92384
F1-score: 0.9221800758634457

Classification Report:

              precision    recall  f1-score   support

           0       0.92      0.92      0.92     12500
           1       0.92      0.92      0.92     12500

    accuracy                           0.92     25000
   macro avg       0.92      0.92      0.92     25000
weighted avg       0.92      0.92      0.92     25000


Confusion Matrix:

[[11503   997]
 [  952 11548]]
```

Plotting the Confusion Matrix

In [ ]:

```python
import matplotlib.pyplot as plt
import seaborn as sns

cm_bert = confusion_matrix(y_true_bert, preds_bert)

plt.figure(figsize=(6, 5))
sns.heatmap(cm_bert, annot=True, fmt='d', cmap='Blues',
            xticklabels=['Negative', 'Positive'],
            yticklabels=['Negative', 'Positive'])
plt.xlabel("Predicted Label")
plt.ylabel("True Label")
plt.title("BERT Confusion Matrix")
plt.show()
```



The BERT model achieved strong performance on the IMDb test dataset. The test accuracy was approximately 0.922, with precision of 0.921, recall of 0.924, and an F1-score of 0.922. These results indicate balanced and reliable performance across both sentiment classes.

The classification report shows that the model performed consistently for both negative and positive reviews, with only minor differences between the two classes. The confusion matrix further confirms this, with relatively low numbers of misclassifications compared to the total number of samples.

Compared to the Logistic Regression and LSTM models, BERT achieved the highest overall performance. This is likely due to its ability to capture deep contextual relationships between words using its transformer architecture, allowing it to better interpret complex sentence structures and subtle sentiment cues.

However, this improved performance comes at a higher computational cost. Training the BERT model required GPU acceleration and significantly more processing time compared to the other models. This highlights an important trade-off between predictive performance and computational efficiency.

Overall, BERT demonstrated the strongest performance in this project and is the most effective model for sentiment classification among those evaluated.

Step 6 – Model Evaluation

In this section, the performance of all models is summarised and compared using the results obtained on the test dataset. The goal is to clearly show how each model performed using standard classification metrics.

The models evaluated are:

- Logistic Regression with TF-IDF features
- LSTM neural network
- BERT transformer model

The evaluation metrics used are accuracy, precision, recall, and F1-score.

Model Performance Summary

Model	Validation Accuracy	Test Accuracy	Precision	Recall	F1-score	Notes
Logistic Regression	0.893	0.879	0.875	0.885	0.880	Strong baseline, fast, interpretable
LSTM	0.687	0.660	0.758	0.468	0.579	Limited performance, requires tuning
BERT	0.919	0.922	0.921	0.924	0.922	Best performance, highest cost

Summary of Results

The Logistic Regression model provides a strong baseline, achieving high accuracy with relatively low computational cost. It performs consistently across both classes and demonstrates that traditional approaches can still be effective for text classification.

The LSTM model was able to learn some sequential patterns, but its performance was significantly lower than expected. In particular, the low recall for positive sentiment shows that the model struggled to correctly identify many positive reviews. This suggests that the model would require further tuning or longer training to reach its full potential.

The BERT model achieved the best performance across all metrics. Its ability to capture contextual meaning in text allowed it to outperform both the baseline and LSTM models. However, this comes at a higher computational cost and longer training time.

Overall, the results highlight a trade-off between model complexity and performance.

Step 7 – Model Comparison and Analysis

In this section, the three models are compared in terms of predictive performance, computational cost, interpretability, and practical usability.

Predictive Performance

The BERT model achieved the highest performance, with a test accuracy of approximately 0.92 and balanced precision and recall. This shows that it is very effective at capturing context in text.

The Logistic Regression model also performed strongly, achieving a test accuracy of approximately 0.88. Despite its simplicity, it provided a competitive baseline and demonstrated that frequency-based representations such as TF-IDF can still be very effective.

The LSTM model achieved a lower test accuracy of approximately 0.66. While it is capable of modelling sequential dependencies, its performance in this implementation did not surpass the simpler baseline model.

Computational Cost

There are clear differences in computational requirements between the models.

Logistic Regression is the most efficient model, with fast training and low computational cost. It can be easily deployed in environments with limited resources.

The LSTM model requires more computation due to sequential processing, but it can still be trained without GPU support.

The BERT model is significantly more expensive, requiring GPU acceleration and longer training time. This makes it less practical in some real-world scenarios.

Interpretability

Logistic Regression is the most interpretable model, as the importance of individual words can be directly analysed through model coefficients.

The LSTM model is less interpretable, as it learns internal representations that are not easily explained.

BERT is the least interpretable, due to its complex transformer architecture.

Overall Comparison

Each model presents different trade-offs.

Logistic Regression offers strong performance with low cost and high interpretability.
LSTM provides sequential modelling but requires careful tuning.
BERT provides the best performance but at a higher computational cost.

The choice of model depends on the specific requirements of the application, including accuracy needs, available resources, and the importance of interpretability.

Step 8 – Findings and Discussion

This project aimed to evaluate different machine learning and deep learning approaches for sentiment classification using the IMDb movie reviews dataset.

Three models were implemented and compared:

- Logistic Regression with TF-IDF features
- LSTM neural network
- BERT transformer model

The results show that the BERT model achieved the highest performance, demonstrating strong accuracy and balanced classification across both sentiment classes. This confirms that transformer-based models are highly effective for natural language processing tasks.

The Logistic Regression model also performed well, providing a strong and efficient baseline. Its performance shows that simpler models can still be competitive when applied with appropriate feature representation.

The LSTM model did not perform as well in this implementation. Although it is designed to capture sequential patterns, the results suggest that it requires more careful tuning, longer training, or a more complex architecture to achieve better performance.

An important observation from this project is that more complex models do not always guarantee better results. While LSTM is theoretically more powerful than Logistic Regression, its performance depends heavily on how it is configured and trained.

In practical terms, the choice of model depends on the balance between performance and computational cost. BERT is the best option when accuracy is the priority, while Logistic Regression may be preferred in situations where efficiency and simplicity are more important.

Overall, the project demonstrates the importance of model selection, proper evaluation, and understanding the trade-offs between different approaches.

A limitation of this project is that only a basic LSTM configuration was explored, and further tuning could improve its performance.

References

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